

Sri Gaura-krishnodaya

"The Rising of Gaura-Krishna"

A Sanskrit poem by Govinda-deva (1758)

Translated from the Sanskrit

Translator's note

The *Sri Sri Gaura-krishnodaya* is a Sanskrit mahakavya in eighteen cantos (about 1,100 verses) on the life of

Sri Chaitanya Mahaprabhu — from the causes of His descent to His departure. Its author, Govinda-deva (Govinda Kavi), was a poet of Orissa who, according to the editor, belonged to the family (line) of Vakreshvara Pandita, an associate of Mahaprabhu; the poem was completed in Shaka 1680 (1758 CE), in the

month of Ashvina. In the colophon of each canto the author calls himself "a bee intoxicated by the honey of

the lotus feet of Sri Gauranga."

The value of the poem. Govinda-deva writes more than two centuries after Mahaprabhu and follows Krishnadasa

Kaviraja's *Sri Chaitanya-charitamrita* almost throughout — he himself names it as his source ("the nectar of

His deeds," 1.4). As a historical source, therefore, the poem is secondary. Its value lies in its poetic retelling in the language of classical kavya, in the love with which the Lord's pastimes are described, and in

a few additions of its own: a prologue in heaven (the Earth before Brahma, Brahma at the Milk Ocean), identifications of the associates (Vishnu as Vishvarupa, Tumburu as Ramananda), the story of how the Infant

would not take the breast until Advaita initiated Shachi into the mantra, and detailed descriptions of the festivals of Puri. Such passages are noted in the footnotes.

The edition. The translation follows the edition of Srila Bhaktisiddhanta Sarasvati (Sri Vimalaprasada Siddhanta Sarasvati; first edition in the year 427 of the Chaitanya era, 1913), 4th ed., Mayapur, Sri Chaitanya Math, 2002 (scan at archive.org, sri-gaura-krsnodayah). The manuscript, as Bhaktisiddhanta writes

in his brief preface, was found in the princely state of Nayagarh (Orissa) and given to him by Rai Sahib Gaurashyama Mahanti; the editor praises the poem for its lucid Sanskrit and wealth of poetic ornament. The

edition contains no commentary or notes; only the poem is translated, and the editor's preface is not.

Principles. The translation is in prose, verse by verse; the numbers are those of the edition (Rupa Gosvami's benedictory verse before the first canto is marked 0). The markers [*p. N*] give the pages of the

PDF scan. The text is printed in Bengali script and is known to us through OCR checked against the scan;

corrupt passages are noted. The footnotes give parallels with the *Chaitanya-charitamrita* (CC), the *Chaitanya-bhagavata* (CB) and the *Gaura-ganoddesha-dipika* (GGD), and theological explanations in the

spirit of the teaching of Srila Bhaktisiddhanta Sarasvati; where the author departs from the CC or from

Gaudiya

Vaishnava theology, the text is translated as it stands and the divergence is noted.

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Canto One. The Descent in Kali

Benediction; the Earth before Brahma, Brahma at the Milk Ocean, the Lord's reply; Krishna's desire to taste Radha's love; who will appear as whom; Advaita calls the Lord; birth of Vishvarupa; the Lord in Shachi's womb (pp. 6–10)

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0. May Hari, the son of Shachi, illumined by a splendour more beautiful than gold, ever be manifest in the cave of your heart — He who out of mercy has descended in the age of Kali to bestow what had not been given for a long time: the treasure of devotion to Himself, the most sublime and radiant rasa.¹
1. Not born among cowherds, He constantly gives bliss; by the Name alone He destroys Agha without entering it; without weapons, by His own [associates], He has removed the burden of the earth — may the wonderful Gaura-Krishna be victorious in the world!²
2. His life, which destroys the impurity of Kali, was once sung in the *Vayu Purana* by the mighty Gautama to his son, as Vishnu declared the truth to the Self-born [Brahma].³
3. Taking it as their basis, noble great poets — Vrindavana [Dasa] and others⁴ — made their pure and harmless speech fruitful in divine poems, to delight the devotees.
4. Although they have already drunk the nectar of the deeds (*charita-amrita*) of Chaitanya-chandra, still there is room for me — as the chakora still drinks the moonlight, though the moon has been drunk by the gods.⁵
5. And so, bowing my head with love to Sri Rupa, Vakreshvara Pandita and the other devotees — detached, yet full of love — I shall tell of His life as best I can.⁶
6. When the age of Kali had set in, which steals away the conduct of the righteous, men became sinful in soul — masters of evil speech, false doctrines and empty logic, destroyers of the joy of the virtuous,
7. greedy for others' wealth and others' wives, lazy in following their own duty, their minds fixed on violence, falsehood and deceit, consenting to walk wrong paths.
8. When the Earth could no longer bear the heavy burden produced by the cruel tread of the feet of men whose hearts were void of compassion, she took the form of a cow and went to the world of the Unborn [Brahma].
9. Though she is the foremost of burden-bearers, she trembled as she told of the unbearable load, like a cow in terror of a hyena's sharp claws; and the Self-born consoled her,
10. saying: "Even when you were oppressed by the Ten-headed one, Kamsa, Keshi and the other demons, you were not like this. Your only friend will again remove your burden, O Earth."⁷
11. Then, taking with him the Earth, who kept sighing in great distress, together with Mahendra and the other chief gods, the Veda-mouthed [Brahma], with Shankara, anxiously went to the Milk Ocean.

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12. He gazed into the waves of the Milk Ocean, rising in pure streams of white water, and, quickly alighting from his carrier, stepped onto the clean, broad shore.
13. And the shore, like a mother, at once refreshed that assembly of worshipful gods who had come from afar, with the soft seat of its lap and with its waters.

14. Then the lord of the Unborn's [world], his fatigue relieved, touching water, with a purified mind meditating on the far-distant Adhokshaja, with palms joined above his head, praised Him:
 15. "Obeisance to You, the Supreme God, O all-pervading, eternal One, whose body is all the worlds; to You whose abode is boundless, whose glory the sages sing, the Great One, Destroyer of the world's evil, the Greatest.
 16. The Supreme Soul, the highest reality, able to unfold the whole multitude of things, eternal, all-pervading, ever-blissful — can I establish Him by any [philosophical] category?
 17. By His will even insentient atoms, attaining a likeness of consciousness, create the world, forming dyads and the rest. By what other means, then, shall I approach Him?⁸
 18. He dwells in the midst of the heart-lotus of those whose minds are purified by eightfold yoga, granting them perfections and shelter — what conduct [of mine] will satisfy Him?
 19. Untouched by afflictions, by the fruits of action and their residues, He placed the Vedas in my mouths; entering the worlds and favouring them, He abides [in them] — under whose control can He be who controls the universe?
 20. He displays before Himself the many-formed Prakriti, full of the gunas, like a dancing girl, while He Himself watches her as a witness — with what visible things can one please Him?
 21. Priests, spreading out the rite of sacrifice, worship Him with Yajur mantras and oblations of ghee, and attain the heavenly kingdom with its imperishable fruit — who in the world is more worthy of worship than He?
 22. Even those unable to describe Him say "not this, not this", calling Him the beyond; words, together with the mind, turn back from Him — who can describe Him with various words of praise?
 23. Some with one, others with two, three, four, five, six, even eight means of knowledge try to prove You — yet they do not know Your nature.⁹
 24. Therefore only by those who with joy and undivided heart render causeless devotion are You seen, and to them You submit — as the ocean belongs to those who enter it, not to those who stand far off, O Boundless One."
 25. As the self-possessed Self-born praised Him thus again and again, the Lord appeared before him and answered what was in his mind — for great souls know the intentions of others:
 26. "I know, O lotus-born: in the world you created a way of life contrary to duty has arisen, and Vishvambhara [the Earth], exhausted by the weight of their feet, sinks lower and lower in sorrow — so I think.¹⁰
 27. In Kali I have no other incarnation who removes such a burden from the earth except Kalki, and for him the time has not yet come. Hence I am perplexed: how, O Earth, are you to be protected?
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28. Sinful men, feeble, short-lived, weak in zeal and resolve, will die at the mere sight of the blaze of My weapons; and if all are slain, how will the world exist?
 29. Go, then, and be attentive; I shall somehow find a means to remove the earth's burden. By My command, take birth on earth in the bodies of My devotees."
 30. Having said this, the Lord at once vanished into the sky, like a fresh thundering cloud, raining upon the eyes and hearts [of the gods].
 31. Then Brahma, having pondered again and again all that he had seen and heard with his many eyes and ears, and holding it in great esteem, told it all to the chief gods, who had not seen or heard the

Unborn One.

32. Drinking the nectar of the Self-born's command, the gods attained supreme bliss: with their minds they worshipped the Lord, with their bodies they returned to their worlds, and with their portions they took birth on earth.
33. Then the Lord of the gods, the all-pervading, the all-knowing, having dismissed the gods, lay in the midst of the ocean and pondered, finding no solution as to how to remove the Earth's burden.
34. At that very moment there arose in Purushottama, whose only abode is Vrindavana, a certain desire that had remained unfulfilled — a special one among His pastimes:
35. "What is My great sweetness like — Mine, who am eternally the concentrate of being, consciousness and bliss, shining with a portion of pure goodness (*vishuddha-sattva*)? Even My own heart is amazed at it.
36. Radha — a drop of whose beauty is coveted by countless Lakshmis, She who worships the Enemy of Keshi and the other asuras — on attaining Me at once becomes intoxicated, perspires, and Her limbs fail Her.
37. What is My beloved's love for Me like? What is the essence of My beauty? What happiness does She feel in tasting Me? These three things, I think, are hard to know.¹¹
38. Therefore I shall surely assume the form of Radhika, come to earth, and especially taste My own sweetness, proper to the pastimes with the gopis."
39. Having decided that this could not be achieved otherwise, Mukunda entered the courtyard of Vishnu's mind and, as if speaking with him face to face, addressed him in words worthy of the highest praise:¹²
40. "O Master of all, by Your will this world is conquered; quickly bring it good. Relying on this nectar-streaming form of Yours as on a ladder, I shall descend.
41. Nanda is known [there] as Jagannatha, and the mother who bore Me as one named Shachi. Becoming the child of these two, the lords of the island city,¹³ I am born on earth.
42. You, before Me, be My elder brother Vishvarupa, the emperor of wandering mendicants; and I, named Sri Krishna Chaitanya, shall become the lord of sannyasis, enduring hardship.¹⁴
43. By the work of singing and glorifying My Names and by charming dances in the madness of love, preaching the yoga of devotion to Myself, I shall deliver these fallen men.
44. Shiva [...] ¹⁵ has become known as Advaita Acharya; and Bala, coming somewhere in Gauda, is Nityananda, the avadhuta full of immeasurable bliss.

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45. Brahma has been born under the name Haridasa; Indra as King Prataparudra; Sandipani as Keshava Bharati; and Paurnameyas as Sita, the mother of his [Advaita's] children.¹⁶
46. Narada, who melts at talks of Me, is Srinivasa, wholly devoted to You; and after him followed Tumburu, under the name Ramananda, knower of the teaching on bhakti.¹⁷
47. Female companions, friends, elders, other relatives, servants and attendants — marked by their qualities and natures, they will be born on earth as communities of devotees.
48. And those who in My various incarnations took shelter of My lotus feet with devoted hearts — some will yet be born, some are already born, and some, know this, are being born now.
49. Gathering together by the ocean¹⁸ along with Me, they — as moneylenders [seek out] debtors — by the manifest power of devotion to Me will make happy the fallen men, [eternal] debtors."

50. Having said this and indicated all that was to be done, [Mukunda] became the object of Vishnu's thoughts; and the Lord of the world, having considered it, rejoiced, for He wished to remove the burden of the earth.¹⁹
51. Then, in the venerable land of teachers, there was born before [the Lord] the first of them, Advaita-deva. With his arguments he demolished the views of heretics, false logicians and Mayavadis.²⁰
52. With arguments from the three Vedas he taught the eternity of the three — the devotee, devotion and the Lord — and also the non-material nature²¹ of Purushottama's pastimes, body and abode.
53. "Not by works, not by progeny," [says] the shruti, [and so say] many smritis; he upheld the superiority of devotion, rejecting even celebrated liberation.²²
54. But, pained by the abundance of the heretics' talk and unable to overcome all that evil speech otherwise, he began to worship the Consort of Radha:
55. every day he worshipped the shalagrama stone marked with the chakra with tender tulasi buds, and cried out: "O Friend of the fallen, deliver these fallen ones now!"²³
56. As he cried out, the Lord appeared in his heart and said: "Do not grieve, friend; soon I shall come to the town of Navadvipa."
57. Then Sita's husband, knowing the Lord's command given in answer to his prayer, rejoiced, and began to seek out the devotees born in various villages and towns.
58. Meanwhile Sri Jagannatha Mishra, having seen eight daughters of his wife — incomparably lovely girls — born and die, grieving over this and desiring a son, worshipped Krishna on the bank of the celestial river [Ganga].²⁴
59. Pleased with his service, Vishnu, the destroyer of the hosts of the wicked, resolved and descended in his wife. And Vishvarupa, after his father had given him initiation, wishing to bestow grace on all mankind, became a mendicant monk, living on alms.²⁵

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60. He did not stay in any chosen holy place of Aryavarta frequented by ascetics under vows — wandering, as befits the noble, he disappeared from sight. Therefore the Mishra again sank into the blinding darkness of great grief, and together with his wife ceaselessly cherished the hope of the rising of the Krishna-moon.
61. Pleased with the couple's japa and worship, Mukunda in the month of Magha, on a certain day, entered the womb of Sri Shachi. From then on both, full of joy, became honoured by the whole world, and Lakshmi herself stayed with them constantly, like a maidservant.²⁶
62. In the *Sri Gaura-krishnodaya*, composed for the delight of connoisseurs by Govinda — a bee intoxicated by tasting the drops of honey that open within the lotus feet of Sri Gauranga, the bull among the lords of sannyasis — this first canto, named "The Descent in Kali," has come to its close.²⁷

Thus ends the first canto of the Sri Gaura-krishnodaya composed by Sri Govinda.

1. This verse is not by Govinda-deva: it is Srila Rupa Gosvami's benedictory verse from the *Vidagdha-madhava* (1.2), quoted by Krishnadasa Kaviraja at the opening of the *Chaitanya-charitamrita* (Adi 1.4). In the edition it stands before verse 1 and is also numbered "1"; for consistent numbering we mark it 0.

2. The verse is built on a contrast with Krishna's pastimes: Krishna was born among cowherds, slew the demon Agha by entering his mouth, and removed the Earth's burden with weapons; Gaura-Krishna, not born among cowherds, destroys sin (*agha*) by the Name alone and removes the Earth's burden without weapons, through His associates. Cf. CC Adi 3: in Kali the Lord comes with His associates and the Holy Name as His weapons.

3. The author refers to a Puranic prophecy about Gaura told by the sage Gautama to his son in the *Vayu Purana*. We have not found it in the commonly known editions of that Purana; such prophecies about Gauranga ascribed to the Puranas circulated in the later tradition. The simile: as Vishnu revealed the truth to Brahma (cf. Bhag. 2.9, the *chatuh-shloki*).
4. *Vṛndāvanādyāḥ*, "Vrindavana and others": most probably Vrindavana Dasa Thakura, author of the *Chaitanya-bhagavata*, and the later biographers; it may also be read "the poets of Vrindavana", i.e. the Gosvamis and Krishnadasa Kaviraja.
5. *Caritāmṛtam* is a pun: "the nectar of the deeds" and the title of Krishnadasa Kaviraja's *Chaitanya-charitamrita*, on which Govinda-deva relies throughout the poem. The chakora is a bird said by poets to feed on moonlight; the moon is regarded as a vessel of nectar drunk by the gods.
6. Vakreshvara Pandita, an associate of Mahaprabhu, to whose family line, according to the editor (Bhaktisiddhanta), the author belonged. *Virakta* ("detached") and *rakta* ("in love", "attached") — a play on words: detached from the world, yet full of love for the Lord.
7. The scene follows the pattern of Bhag. 10.1.17–23 (the Earth as a cow before Brahma prior to Krishna's appearance). The Ten-headed one is Ravana.
8. An allusion to the Vaisheshika doctrine of the world composed of atoms (pairs of atoms, *dvyanuka*): according to the verse, even atoms create only by the Lord's will, endowed by Him with consciousness. Verse 16 likewise plays on the Vaisheshika term *padartha* ("category").
9. The number of valid means of knowledge (*pramana*) differs among the philosophical schools, from one (the Charvakas: perception) to eight (the Pauranikas).
10. *Viśvambharā*, "She who bears the universe", is a name of the Earth; at the same time a hint at Mahaprabhu's childhood name, Vishvambhara.
11. Krishna's three desires are those of Svarupa Damodara's famous verse (CC Adi 1.6; discussed in Adi 4): the greatness of Radha's love, the wonderful sweetness of Krishna that Radha relishes, and the happiness She feels in relishing it. Cf. Adi 4: the external cause of the appearance is the removal of the Earth's burden and the preaching of the yuga-dharma; the internal cause is these three desires.
12. Mukunda (Krishna) addresses Vishnu, who lies in the ocean. This is Govinda-deva's way of showing Vishnu's part in Krishna's descent; according to the CC (Adi 4), when Krishna appears, Vishnu the maintainer is present within Him and the yuga-dharma is preached through Him. In the poem Vishnu is then born as Vishvarupa (vv. 42, 59) — see note 14.
13. *Dvāpa-pura* — probably "the city on the island", i.e. Navadvipa ("nine islands"); the text may be corrupt.
14. A peculiarity of the poem: Vishnu, whom Krishna addresses, becomes Vishvarupa, Gaura's elder brother. Neither the CC nor Karnapura says so: according to the *Gaura-ganoddeshā-dīpikā*, Vishvarupa is Sankarshana (Baladeva), and according to the tradition followed by Bhaktisiddhanta, Vishvarupa after his departure entered into Nityananda.
15. The word *śīlāyāsyā* in the edition is unclear (probably corrupt); perhaps Advaita's connection with the shalagrama stone (v. 55) is meant. On Advaita as Shiva (Sadashiva), cf. the *Gaura-ganoddeshā-dīpikā*, where Advaita is Maha-Vishnu and also Sadashiva (CC Adi 6: Advaita is Maha-Vishnu, "non-different from Hari").
16. The list of incarnations (vv. 44–46) partly agrees with Karnapura's *Gaura-ganoddeshā-dīpikā* (Haridasa — Brahma; Keshava Bharati — Sandipani; Sita — Yogamaya, i.e. Purnamasi), partly differs from it: according to the GGD, Prataparudra is King Indradyumna, not Indra. *Sītā-prasūḥ* may also be read differently: "Sita and his [Advaita's] mother".
17. "To You" — to Vishnu, whom Krishna is addressing. Srivasa as Narada agrees with the GGD. Tumburu is the celestial singer, Narada's companion; according to the GGD, however, Ramananda Raya is Arjuna (and the gopi Arjuniya), not Tumburu.
18. *Samayā samudram*, "by the ocean", i.e. at Nilachala (Puri), where the associates will gather around the Lord.
19. That is, Vishnu, the maintainer of the world, accepted Krishna's design: the external purpose (removing the Earth's burden) will be fulfilled together with the internal one.
20. The edition reads *mārikānām*, evidently a misprint for *māyikānām* ("Mayavadis", followers of the doctrine of maya). On Advaita's preaching before the Lord's appearance see CC Adi 3, 13.
21. The edition reads *sa prākṛtatvam* ("materiality"), but the sense requires *aprākṛtatvam*, "non-material, transcendental nature": the teaching that the Lord's pastimes, body and abode are not material is one of the foundations of Gaudiya Vaishnava theology (cf. Bhaktisiddhanta on *apṛakṛta*). We translate according to the sense.
22. A quotation from the *Mahānārāyaṇa Upaniṣad* (*na karmaṇā na prajāyā dhanena tyāgenaike amṛtatvam ānaśuḥ*, "not by works, not by progeny, not by wealth — by renunciation alone some attained immortality"), turned here into an argument for bhakti. The words *na sādhyaty ādi* are corrupt.
23. Cf. CC Adi 3 (closing verses): Advaita, seeing the world devoid of devotion, worships the shalagrama with Ganga water and tulasi leaves and loudly calls on Krishna. Govinda-deva adds the Lord's reply in Advaita's heart (v. 56).

24. CC Adi 13: eight daughters were born to Jagannatha Mishra and Shachi and died; then Vishvarupa was born.
25. Here (v. 59) Govinda-deva apparently means the birth of Vishvarupa as the descent of Vishnu (cf. v. 42). On Vishvarupa's sannyasa see CC Adi 13, 15.
26. CC Adi 13: in the month of Magha, Shaka 1406, the Lord entered the bodies of Jagannatha and Shachi; their house was filled with abundance, and Mishra and Shachi perceived wonderful signs.
27. The colophon stanza recurs (with variations) at the end of each canto. *Kalāvataṛaṇa* is ambiguous: "the descent in Kali" and "the descent of the portions" (*kala*, partial incarnations, the associates) — both senses suit the content of the canto.
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Canto Two. The Power of the Lord

Shachi's pregnancy and the thirteenth month; the Lord's appearance on the Phalguna full moon during the eclipse; the Infant refuses the breast until Advaita initiates Shachi into the mantra; Sita and the goddesses visit the Infant; the naming; the first rice; the footprints and the thirty-two marks of a great personality (pp. 11–14)

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1. Then Shachi, the beloved of the best of Mishras, equal to the celestial Shachi in purity of nature, showed the signs of pregnancy and took on the beauty of the autumn sky when the moon is hidden by clouds.
2. As she grew thinner day and night, the pallor of her body increased; as her longing for unheard-of foods gradually grew, so did her belly.
3. Again and again she was sick, yet her spirit did not flag; even at night she took no pleasure in union with her husband, her love of amusement waned, and even in bed, after jesting, she could not sleep.
4. Darkness quickly seized the tips of her full breasts — she whose eyes were those of a timid doe — as Rahu of old seized the jar of nectar divided in two in the quarrel of gods and asuras.¹
5. After some days, she saw at night that her womb shone like the sky, and slowly told her husband of this wonder, beyond the minds of those who dwell on earth.
6. Hearing her words and seeing her form, which could astonish the heart, Mishra said to his virtuous wife: "Some great soul will be born."
7. Some more months passed, and again the month of Magha came — the time [for the birth]; yet the child did not come forth, and both of them grew anxious.
8. Then Nilambara Chakravarti, having considered everything, came himself and said to his well-mannered daughter: "Do not grieve, my daughter: in the thirteenth month a most beautiful son will be born to you."²
9. And now spring arose in the world, nourishing tender shoots on the rows of trees; the quarters shone with the breezes from the Malaya hills, laden with the pollen of lotuses;
10. the forests grew lovely with clusters of blossoms, groves of ketaki opened, and all was filled with the song of male cuckoos intoxicated by the juice of young mango shoots;
11. the humming of bees drunk with nectar troubled the hearts of wives whose husbands were away — [spring became] the first teacher of the science of lament; all around was filled with the fragrance of flowers.
12. The tithi of the Phalguna full moon arrived; the moon, lord of the Phalguni asterism, shone with blazing rays; Leo [was rising], and the year [of the] Shaka [era] reached one thousand four hundred and seven.³
13. At that hour, when the dwellers of the three worlds rejoiced, the Lord was born, bringing glory to His mother. Seeing that spotless moon in the courtyard, darkness swallowed the spotted moon.⁴
14. The darkness of the eclipse spread everywhere outside and the darkness of ignorance within people — Gaurachandra, risen with His own radiance, dispelled them, as the sun dispels the mist.
15. As He lay in the courtyard and, under the pretext of sweet crying, uttered His own name — the essence of all learning — the Shrutis came to Him like women, as they came to Hiranyagarbha lying on the lotus from Hari's navel.

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16. Then the best of Mishras joyfully, seeing the boy with His umbilical cord, performed [the rites over] Him with the brahmins — Him who was like a blazing image of Kama cast of molten gold.
17. The courtyard of Mishra's house was filled with a rain of celestial flowers together with curd and kunkuma; the quarters resounded with the sound of celestial trumpets, mingled with his [earthly] music, song and dance.
18. Then the women, now His own kin, joyfully brought [the Infant] out, having cut the cord in the birth chamber; and people gave gifts in many ways, bathing in the waters of the Ganga on the pretext of the eclipse.⁵
19. Then the Lord, displaying on earth His power and [the importance] of the supreme mantra of the name, would not drink at His mother's breast; and the women, at a loss, did not know what to say.⁶
20. Then the lord Advaita, learning of the birth of Mahaprabhu, told Haridasa of it and, eager to see Him, the noble one set out himself with his wife, taking fine gifts.
21. And Sita — leaving behind her husband with the porters carrying the baggage — was brought by very swift palanquin-bearers to the house of the best of Mishras the next day, ahead [of him].⁷
22. Seeing the women sitting dejected beside the Infant, the Acharya's wife, full of compassion, with a bewildered look, wise, said not a word.
23. The brahmin women bowed to her who had come to the house of the wife of the king of the twice-born and told her what fate had done; and, distressed like female chakravakas,⁸ they spent all that night without sleep.
24. On the third day he, knower of the hidden [Advaita], entered the house of Shachi's astonished husband, whose mind was fixed on his radiant son who had not drunk the nectar of his mother's breast.
25. He bowed and honoured the noble Acharya who had come to his house, and in conversation, exchanging wishes of well-being, he somehow told him of his Infant's behaviour.
26. Having heard Mishra's words, [Advaita] drank in with his eyes the nectar of the sweetness of his son's body, and then, with firm reverence, withdrawing into an inner room, secretly disclosed to the Lord [his] confidential [request]:
27. "Lord, You have descended in Kali to fulfil [the needs] of the sinful. If You do not drink the juice of Your mother's breast, how will You remain in this world among the living?
28. So let Shachi's austerity ripen quickly: drink her milk at once! It was You Yourself who earlier began to act as a son to obtain this — how then are You now averse to it?"
29. The Lord, heeding and honouring his request, full of the taste of his friendship, said to the Acharya: "O best of the twice-born, do you not know how sinful it is to take impure food?
30. This body — an abode of excrement and urine, like a corpse — always grows impure; without initiation from Me, without initiation into My mantra, it does not become pure by any ablutions.
31. Therefore, with this great mantra of initiation into Me, purify My mother; then I will drink milk." Saying this, the Lord gave the great mantra to the best of the twice-born.⁹

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32. And the best of Acharyas handed to Shachi at once both the mantra and the son — both supremely great; and, receiving both at once, the goddess shone like Aditi in heaven.

33. Then the people, their cherished wish fulfilled, their eyes flooded with tears of joy, danced to the kirtan of the holy name of Hari, delighting even the Yavanas.¹⁰
 34. The women of the town, impelled by love, losing their ornaments in their haste, forgetting children, husbands and household tasks, calling one another — high and low alike —
 35. agitated by the wish to see Mishra's extraordinary son, came to his house and brought some gifts — valuables and things to eat.
 36. Arundhati, Haimavati, Sarasvati, Shachi and other chief goddesses, assuming the form of brahmins' wives, also entered his house, unsuspected by anyone.¹¹
 37. Seeing Him — the one beauty among the sons of the world, a pleasure-house for the herds of does that were their glances — they blessed Him many times and with difficulty returned to their abodes.
 38. When seven days had passed, [Shachi] bathed in warm water, performed the rite of ablution and adorned herself; and her relatives festively performed for mother and son the rite of coming out [of the birth chamber].
 39. On the next day Nilambara Chakravarti too, master of astrology, came, eager to see his grandson, and told his son-in-law the wonderful fruit [of the positions] of the planets and stars at the Infant's birth.
 40. When [the period of] impurity was over, Shachi's husband, now purified, invited all the brahmins, sadhus and Vaishnavas and with great enthusiasm and festivity performed his son's name-giving ceremony.
 41. Seating on his lap the Infant, adorned with a priceless necklace, armlets, gold coins, tinkling bells, a belt of little bells, beautiful bracelets and the rest, Mishra came out to the assembly
 42. and said to all assembled: "This son out of love will sustain the whole universe — so let Him bear the name Vishvambhara; and since in Him [all] consciousness (*chit*) is gathered, He is called Chaitanya.
 43. He is also Gaura, for He shines like gold, and likewise Krishna, for He attracts every heart. Since both these [names] refer to Him alone and are in accord in Him, let Him be known as Gaura-Krishna."¹²
 44. Having blessed the Infant, having dined and received honours, they took leave of Mishra with fine words full of affection and went to their homes.
 45. And the people, hearing those names, used them — names of great fruit — as weapons to destroy sins, and again and again did battle with the enemies: lust and the rest.
 46. Then the best of Acharyas with his wife, gladly accepting the worship offered by Mishra's wife, knowing what he had to do, went home, constantly remembering the Infant, the ornament of the three worlds.
 47. Then He, possessed of undiminishing radiance, displaying a series of His powers along with charming play, nectar to the eyes of the world, grew in body day by day like the young moon.
 48. One day Mishra, surrounded by the best of brahmins who had performed their daily fire rites, with great festivity performed the rite of first taking outdoors the boy, who shone like Kumara.
- [p. 14]
49. When He had begun to crawl slowly about on His knees and hands, on an auspicious day He delighted His parents by tasting soft rice with milk.

50. The son babbled half-words, laughed for joy, showing His shining little teeth, and toddled here and there, stumbling — and the couple rejoiced in Him.
51. The best of Mishras, free of envy, planning an annual festival on his son's birthday, invited brahmins learned in mantras and agamas and honoured them.
52. Then at dawn Shachi, awaking, saw in the inner rooms the beautiful footprints of her son, whose little feet were wet with turmeric, and [wondered]: "What are these unknown [prints]?"
53. She told Mishra, and he, deciding that they were the footprints of the Deity [of Krishna], the Enemy of Kamsa, rejoiced with an extraordinary feeling [in his heart] and sprinkled them with tears of joy.¹³
54. Then Shachi eagerly took her son, who had woken, gave Him the nectar of her breast, washed Him, and, rubbing His foot, noticed marks on it.
55. Again she said to her husband: "What is this, ah! The [same] prints shine on our son's foot!" Hearing this, he gladly and quickly examined His tender foot, red as a japa flower —
56. marked with signs: the wheel-line, flag, thunderbolt, jambu fruit, goad, lotus, svastika, barleycorn, leaf, pennant, octagon, chariot, waterpot, cow's hoofprint, triangle, fish, conch, banyan, moon and bow —
57. a lovely, safe cage giving festival to the birds of the eyes; from frequent embraces, kisses and the like it became wet with tears of joy.¹⁴
58. Then the maternal grandfather came and, his heart melted, said to the assembly: "I knew the greatness of this Infant from looking at His horoscope — what more is there to say?"
59. Seeing in the Infant's limbs fineness in five, length and redness in seven, prominence in six, and depth, shortness and breadth in three, [he said]:¹⁵
60. "Therefore this Hari who has been born is a great personality (*mahapurusha*); there is no other deliverer for you from the sufferings of the world. Serve His lotus feet with an undoubting heart — He is your treasure here."
61. These words of Nilambara Chakravarti settled in their ears, and the peaceful best of Vedic scholars, confirming them by the views of the Shrutis, took shelter of Him. And Mishra, having celebrated the Lord's birthday as his means allowed, considered himself and his wife blessed to be the parents of such a son.
62. In the *Sri Gaura-krishnodaya*, composed for the delight of connoisseurs by Govinda — a bee intoxicated by tasting the drops of honey that open within the lotus feet of Sri Gauranga, the bull among the lords of sannyasis — the second canto, named "The Power of the Lord," has come to its close.

Thus ends the second canto of the Sri Gaura-krishnodaya composed by Sri Govinda.

1. Darkening of the nipples is a sign of pregnancy. The comparison with Rahu seizing the nectar at the churning of the ocean: the nipples are like darkness seizing the two halves of the jar of nectar.
2. CC Adi 13: the Lord stayed in Shachi's womb for thirteen months; Nilambara Chakravarti, Shachi's father, calculated by the stars and reassured the family.
3. The year is written in word-numerals (*bhuta-sankhya*): *abdhi* "ocean" = 7 (the seven oceans), *jagat-śata* = 1400 — i.e. Shaka 1407 (February 1486 CE). CC Adi 13: the Lord appeared in Shaka 1407, on the Phalgun full moon, in the evening, in simha-lagna (the sign of Leo).
4. Birth during a lunar eclipse — CC Adi 13: Rahu swallowed the moon, and during the eclipse all the people loudly chanted "Hari! Hari!" The poet plays on this: seeing the new, flawless Moon (Gaura), darkness out of shame swallowed the old, spotted moon.
5. CC Adi 13: during the eclipse people bathed in the Ganga and gave alms, chanting the names of Hari.

6. The beginning of a story absent from the CC: the Infant refuses the breast until Shachi receives the mantra from Advaita (vv. 19–32). This is the "legend of Shachi's initiation by Advaita" that scholars name as Govinda-deva's chief independent addition. A similar story is found in the *Advaita-prakasha* (ch. 10), where Advaita initiates Mishra and Shachi.
 7. CC Adi 13 tells of Sita Thakurani coming with gifts to the newborn (without Advaita); in Govinda-deva Sita comes first and Advaita follows on the third day.
 8. Female chakravakas, according to poetic convention, spend the night separated from their mates, pining until dawn.
 9. Govinda-deva puts into the Infant's mouth a teaching on the necessity of initiation (*diksha*): without it the body and food are not purified. Here the idea takes the form of a pastime: according to Gaudiya Vaishnava teaching, Shachi is an eternal associate of the Lord (Yashoda in Vraja; see 1.41) and there is no impurity in her; the Lord arranges this to instruct the world. Bhaktisiddhanta constantly stressed the importance of *diksha*, citing the *Hari-bhakti-vilasa* (2.12): as bell-metal becomes gold by alchemy, so a person becomes twice-born by initiation.
 10. *Yavanān apītavān* is apparently corrupt; we read *yavanān api*, "even the Yavanas" (Muslims). Cf. CC Adi 13: at the Lord's birth even Muslims, seeing the Hindus, jokingly repeated the name of Hari.
 11. CC Adi 13: the goddesses — wives of the celestials — came in the guise of brahmins' wives and, recognised by no one, saw the Infant. Haimavati is Parvati; Shachi here is Indra's consort.
 12. An explanation of the names and of the title of the poem. The naming Vishvambhara is in CC Adi 14 (according to the CC, the name Krishna Chaitanya was given at *sannyasa*; cf. 1.42). "Gaura" and "Krishna" as designations of one and the same subject (grammatical *samanadhikaranya*) give the "Gaura-Krishna" of the poem's title.
 13. CC Adi 14: in the house were found the prints of small feet with the marks of flag, thunderbolt, conch, wheel and fish; Jagannatha and Shachi concluded that Bala-Gopala (their Deity) was walking about the house, and later saw the same marks on their son's feet.
 14. The list of marks on the Lord's foot (v. 56) is partly unclear in the print and OCR; we translate according to the usual list of marks on Krishna's feet. The foot is compared to a "cage" for the "birds of the eyes": a glance once caught in it can no longer fly away.
 15. The thirty-two signs of a mahapurusha — CC Adi 14.15 quotes the same verse ("five long, five fine, seven red, six prominent, three short, three broad, three deep"). Govinda-deva's count differs somewhat (the print is probably corrupt here).
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Canto Three. Childhood

Crying stilled by Hari's name; the Infant eats clay; the pilgrim brahmin; the thief; pranks; striking His mother and the coconut; the girls at the Ganga and the meeting with Lakshmi; "there is no pure and impure"; the father's anger and Mishra's dream (pp. 15–19)

[p. 15]

1. The boy, indulging in childish pranks, fondled by the women, by His antics intoxicated the hearts of those who watched Him, shedding tears of joy.
2. If Mishra's son cried and no toy could console Him, the women would begin to chant the names of Hari — and He would stop crying.¹
3. Once He, with His row of tender little teeth, was playing in the courtyard with all the boys; His mother, seeing the little one eating clay,
4. held Him back, shook her finger at Him, scolded Him and said: "Ah, what recklessness! What do You want, child, why do You eat this nasty clay?"
5. In my house there are many foods made of cream and sugar; why have You given them up as if they were bitter? Ah, where has Your good sense gone!"
6. Hearing His mother's words, the Lord, with a look of mingled fear and surprise, said to her: "Mother, what you tell Me is not false, but consider a child's words.
7. All this food is only earth; taste is present in all things. Is not everything one at its root? Why then do you divide [things] into edible and inedible?"
8. Amazed at the child's speech, that jewel among women said to Him: "If all food here is earth, still one kind is wholesome and another harmful.
9. Payasa and the like nourish, while clay and the like cause grave illness. Therefore, son, people, after due thought, eat what is wholesome and sweet, not what is harmful.
10. A living being lives in a healthy body that grows by wholesome food; otherwise it quickly wastes away. Look, dear one, at an example:
11. in a very smooth clay pot water stays pure for a long time; but if it gets into a lump of clay, it quickly dries up and is seen no more."
12. Hari, wishing to conceal Himself, approved His mother's words and said: "Mother, why didn't you tell Me this before? Now I won't eat it."
13. Saying this, the golden beauty [Gaura], in the presence of the town women, began to drink at His mother's breast; and Shachi, taking in the child's words, rejoiced in her astonished heart.²
14. Once a certain brahmin guest, tormented by hunger, asked her for cooked rice; and Shachi gladly gave the twice-born all he needed for cooking.
15. He cooked the rice and, as he first began to offer it to Vishnu, the Lord in a trice ate the rice, vegetables and the rest — and laughed.

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16. Seeing such strange behaviour in a child, [the brahmin] again with difficulty, keeping calm, cooked rice with vegetables — and the Lord again ate it all before his eyes.
17. Then the brahmin, after chasing Him away many times and making sure He was sitting on His mother's lap, cooked again in agitation and offered it to the Lord.

18. And at once, seeing Him eating the rice with a joyful face, he said: "Well! What a small tummy You have, child, yet it is never filled with this food!
 19. Mothers in the world gladly and happily feed many children; ah, what is this: with all her wealth she cannot feed one child!"
 20. Hearing these words, He was amused and, wishing to elevate this [brahmin] devoted to Vedic rites, at once disclosed His position and said to the brahmin, who shone with spiritual power:
 21. "I am not a hungry brahmin, nor is My stomach so very large; but what My devotee offers Me again and again I cannot let go by, even if it is a trifle."
 22. Having spoken this nectarean speech, the Lord, rejoicing, revealed Himself before him in the form that stirs Gokula — the colour of a raincloud, with a flute in His hands.
 23. Beholding Him with his own eyes, praising Him with beautiful words and bowing down, the brahmin partook of His remnants and at once attained the fulfilment of all aims.³
 24. One night, when His family were asleep, a certain thief, greedy for gold ornaments, carried off the Lotus-eyed One and ran away, hiding his steps.
 25. The people searching the house did not find the child in the inner room; their feet slipped on their tears, and at every step blinding grief overtook them.
 26. Gaurachandra, seeing His relatives in despair and Himself carried off by the thief for gain, made the thief feel His power and stole away his mind.
 27. And the thief, having wandered long and no longer able to carry the heavy burden, in the morning entered in amazement Mishra's house, full of cries of grief.
 28. The face of the child, sitting on the high shoulder of the thief, who stood stock-still, was like a reflection in a mirror set in a pillar — and became for the people a source of blessing.
 29. Shachi, beside herself with joy, pressing to her heart the son who had returned as if from the dead, let even the thief go in peace and spoke not one harsh, angry word to him.⁴
 30. With a band of strong boys He would enter the houses of the townsfolk like a thief, smash the pots and eat up all the food.
 31. Then some of the boys He had beaten came and said to Shachi: "Mother, because of your son's prowess we'll probably have to leave the village!
 32. Your fine little son eats up all the food by force, breaks the dishes, blocks the way of the little ones and thrashes them — he blazes like the submarine fire!"
- [p. 17]
33. Having heard the children's words, Shachi, threatening, said to her son: "Why do You trouble everyone, You rascal? You don't obey what I tell You!"
 34. Then the Lord, rubbing His eyes with His little fists, [struck] His mother; and the women, catching her, cried out in jest: "Oh, she's been killed!"
 35. Seeing His mother suddenly fall senseless, Hari grew alarmed. One woman said: "If someone brings coconut water to the one who was struck, she will surely revive."
 36. No sooner had these pleasant words been spoken than He, eager to bring His mother back to life, went out — and there He stood, having brought a coconut.⁵
 37. Seeing this miracle, the brahmin women considered Him superhuman; noticing this, the Lord concealed His greatness under the pretence of singing and dancing.

38. Once on the bank of the Ganga He, the golden one, saw some town girls observing a maidens' vow, and with a smile, without a second thought, said to them:
39. "To what god in the form of a mantra are all you girls offering worship? Here I am before you, the giver of boons; worship Me, the God above the gods."
40. At these words some, feeling dislike, ran away from the place of worship; but others, with tenderness in their hearts, shy and afraid, respectfully worshipped Him.
41. Pleased with this, He, an ocean of kindness, gave the girls a fitting blessing: "May wealth, the love of a good husband and seven sons soon come to you."
42. And to the girls who had run away He said in play, with a show of respect: "If you go away without worshipping Me, you will surely get an old husband."
43. When He said this, one of the flock of girls who had come with offerings — clever in argument, but frightened — suddenly came up to Hari and said:
44. "Hey, dear one, you are our brother, since you live in the same town with us! Why do you laugh at us, friend? It's not sensible — with girls..."
45. Don't curse us: we will worship your feet, tender as shoots, right now." Saying this and casting sidelong glances at Him, they at once began to worship Him.
46. Anointed by their worship, the clever one, pleased, at once showered the little girls with many blessings and returned to town as if nothing had happened.⁶
47. One morning the beautiful daughter of the brahmin Vallabha, pure in heart, came to the bank of the celestial river to worship her chosen deity.
48. Seeing before Him her with intoxicating eyes, born of a portion of His beloved, devoted to her dear one, the Lord, remembering their former relationship, spoke to her under the guise of a child's mischief:
49. "Whom are you worshipping so earnestly, O lovely-eyed one, and for what desire — which celestial — leaving aside Me, the Great Lord who grants desired fruits, here on the bank of the celestial river?"
50. Hearing this, she — from the feeling that welled up, from joy at His glance and from childish shyness — at once, glancing sideways, covered her whole face.
51. Then these two, who were only pretending to be children, casting off by force the cover made by the art of time, sat rejoicing at heart, exchanging glances full of rasa.
52. When Mishra's son, unabashed, quickly removed her veil, she too, unashamed in her childhood, worshipped Him with fragrant flowers and the rest.
53. "Today I have learned your desire, sweet one; so it shall be, and not otherwise." Pleasing her with such meaningful words, Hari accepted her offering.⁷
54. Once Shachi went to punish her son for His pranks; and He, fearless, as if frightened, ran far away and sat down in an unclean place.
55. Seeing her son touching something unclean, she angrily scolded Him hard: "Bathe! Go into the waters of the Ganga, son, otherwise You may not enter the house."
56. Hari, deftly answering His mother's words and as if pointing out the path of liberation, said: "Mother, what have I done? What are you thinking, grieving Me with your words?"
57. This whole visible world consists of Me; consider truly: it is not as it appears. Here the activity of the Self appears as transformation, like a conjuror's magic.

58. So is there anywhere anything pure or impure? In reality [I am] apart from everything: I, all-pervading, though present [everywhere], am like the sky, distinct from all, unstained."⁸

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59. Hearing these words of the child, full of truth, she grew calm in amazement. And Hari, pretending a child's fright, spoke again as if in childish mischief.

60. Once the father, though he loved his son tenderly, scolded Him for His great mischief and admonished Him with stern words; and at night both [parents] slept long.

61. A certain god, angered, said to him in a dream: "Ah, why do you scold the Great Lord, thinking Him your son? Mishra, your efforts are in vain.

62. He who gave the Vedas to the lotus-born, by whose guidance the world continues to exist — to Him you show your authority! You are [as if] showing the wind its way."

63. Hearing this, he, without pride, answered the best of the twice-born: "I know that what you say is not false; but the upbringing of a son is the father's duty.

64. If the son is well brought up, the father gains fame; if not, he is blamed in the world. This is the father's highest duty; why then do you, not knowing this, speak so?"

65. The brahmin at once said to him: "Good Mishra, your words have now revealed your pure parental love; we shall find none equal to it."

66. Having thus satisfied each other, these two best of the twice-born gladly ended [their talk]. Then Shachi told her awakened husband what she had seen in a dream about the child:

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67. "My lord, some beautiful exalted gods took up the sweetly babbling child and suddenly vanished before the eyes of the townsfolk."

68. When she had said this, he, touching her, told her his own dream. Their conversation gave joy not only to them — but also to those who hear [of it].⁹

69. Thus the treasure-house of pastimes, dwelling in Sri Navadvipa-dhama, performed His childhood pastimes, worthy of a wandering Kama; who in the three worlds can sing of all that He did each day, giving joy by [His] deeds?

70. And yet, as I heard the truthful account of Him, so, after reflection, I have sung His charming childhood pastimes, abridging them as nectar for the righteous.

71. In the *Sri Gaura-krishnodaya*, composed for the delight of connoisseurs by Govinda — a bee intoxicated by tasting the drops of honey that open within the lotus feet of Sri Gauranga, the bull among the lords of sannyasis — the third canto, devoted mainly to describing His childhood, has come to its close.

72. ...Meditate on the feet of Sri Gauranga for release from the cycle of births.¹⁰

Thus ends the third canto of the Sri Sri Gaura-krishnodaya composed by Sri Govinda.

1. CC Adi 13, 14: whenever the women chanted the name of Hari, the crying Infant fell silent; therefore the women chanted constantly around Him.

2. The clay episode — CC Adi 14: the Lord tells His mother that all food is a transformation of earth, and His mother explains the difference between wholesome and harmful by the example of a clay pot and a lump of clay. Govinda-deva closely retells the CC. The child's words in v. 7 sound like a doctrine of the oneness of all — according to the CC the Lord speaks thus in play and it is His mother who instructs Him; see also note 8.

3. The pilgrim brahmin (tirthika) — CC Adi 14 (briefly) and in detail the CB, Adi-khanda: three times the Infant eats the food offered to Krishna and reveals to the brahmin His form as Krishna.

4. The kidnapping of the Infant by thieves for His ornaments — CB, Adi-khanda (two thieves there); briefly mentioned in CC Adi 14. In Govinda-deva there is one thief.
 5. CC Adi 14: angry with His mother, the Lord struck her; she fell unconscious, and the women said she would revive if her son brought a coconut; He at once brought two coconuts. In Govinda-deva, one.
 6. The girls worshipping the gods on the bank of the Ganga, and the Lord demanding worship for Himself — CC Adi 14 (in detail, CB, Adi-khanda). The blessings (a rich, handsome husband, seven sons) and the threat (an old husband) are as in the CC.
 7. The meeting with Lakshmipriya at the Ganga — CC Adi 14: they recognised each other; the Lord demanded worship, and she worshipped Him in her mind. "Born of a portion of His beloved": Lakshmipriya is an incarnation of Lakshmi (GGD). Govinda-deva adds the scene with the veil (vv. 51–52); his epithet "only pretending to be children" stresses that this is the play of eternal consorts, not mundane passion.
 8. CC Adi 14: the Lord sat on discarded pots and, to His mother's reproach, replied that there is neither pure nor impure — all is one (a speech in the manner of the non-dualist doctrine); Shachi in reply explained the rules of purity. According to Bhaktisiddhanta, such words of the child are play, not His teaching; later the Lord Himself refutes the Mayavadis (Madhya 6, 25). In Govinda-deva, v. 57, "it is not as it appears" must not be taken as a denial of the reality of the world; cf. the CC's teaching that the world is real, though temporary, a manifestation of the Lord's external energy.
 9. CC Adi 14: Jagannatha Mishra once scolded his son, and at night in a dream a brahmin rebuked him: "Your son is no ordinary child"; Mishra answered that even if his son is God, a father must bring Him up, and the brahmin praised his love. Shachi's dream (v. 67) is Govinda-deva's addition.
 10. Half a shloka printed after the colophon stanza; its beginning is apparently lost.
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Canto Four. The Marriage

Beginning of studies, upanayana, study under Gangadasa; the Lord teaches bhakti and introduces vows; Vishvarupa's return and departure (Shankararanya); the swoon after betel; the passing of Jagannatha Mishra; the marriage with Lakshmipriya; the beauty of young Gaura (pp. 20–23)

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1. And now He, adorned with the beauty of boyhood polished by good upbringing, with golden, tender, lovely limbs — after His father had performed for Him the tonsure and other rites — on a certain day, under favourable Jupiter, Moon, asterism and Sun, began to learn His letters.
2. Holding hard chalk in His little hand, the Lord, eloquent in all the sciences, began to write on the ground, made bright by the gleam of His gold ornaments, the letters — vowels and consonants — in order.
3. The king of the twice-born on earth [Mishra] performed the upanayana of his son, of sweetest form and great glory, who had reached the middle of boyhood — in the fifth season of the year, after the rains — with unsurpassed rites and festivities with alms for the poor.¹
4. Having grasped within a few days the secret of the rows of words, He — wishing to master the science that [for others] requires long study — went with His father, bearing gifts, to the great teacher Gangadasa to study grammar.
5. Following the teacher's word, His mind intent on listening, instructed only once, without effort, He learned and began to expound the beautiful *Kalapa* grammar with its terms, sandhi, nouns, verbs and meanings.²
6. Then within a few days, having become expert in sutras and commentaries, having learned poetry, the Shruti and the science of ornaments of speech, having studied the great *Bhashya* too, He took a liking to Nyaya, Vaisheshika and the other sciences.
7. As a helmsman effortlessly brings a sturdy ship, driven by a favourable wind, to shore, so the teacher swiftly brought this Supreme Person to the far shore of the ocean of the various sciences — and reached it himself.
8. From then on the Lord, establishing that the injunctions [of scripture] speak of devotion to Vishnu, and showing its distinction as the supreme goal from karma, knowledge, yoga and the rest, became a teacher in all lands.
9. Even His chatter, usually like the Vedas and faultless, no one would contravene; only the heretic bent on hell did not honour it — as a dying man rejects medicine.
10. Wishing to raise up the fierce hordes of heretics on earth walking a false path by the law of the Lord-Protector, He introduced vows for Hari's appearance day and other [festivals], for the ekadashis of Kartika, and arranged festivities.
11. One day He, a moon among the host of sages, lovingly and humbly induced His mother to observe fasts and vows on the days of the Conqueror of the Daityas; and Mishra, delighted, began to do the same.³
12. Some days later the peaceful Vishvarupa, having ascertained the descent of the Lord and wishing to see His incomparably beautiful form, unexpectedly entered his father's town in the dress of a brahmachari.
13. Seeing him, the people there thought he had returned from another world and rejoiced greatly; and Mishra, with his [younger] son, brought him into his house.

14. Joyfully feeding him various sweet dishes and constantly caring for him, beautiful as Kama, Mishra after some time thought it fitting for the youth to marry.
15. Learning of his father's intention, Vishvarupa soon, addressing Vishvambhara in private, said to Him: "You are the Lord of the world; purify the people who cling to deceptive family life by bestowing prema-bhakti upon them."

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16. Having somehow told Him this in secret, he embraced Him tightly in great love and, quick of mind, left fearlessly at night while the whole world slept — [taking] the name Shankararanya.⁴
17. When this son — pure, beautiful in body, of pure character and brief [household] life — had left the house, Mishra and Shachi, stricken with grief, bereft of all joy, wept aloud.
18. To console them, the magnanimous One said to His parents: "Why do you weep for a son who has gone forth to wander? He has become a purifier of the whole world, and of us too; for no one grieves over a son who has become a lord of the earth.
19. And I will serve you here, venerable ones — with food, clothing, bedding, oil massage and ointments for the whole body. This is the happiness that parents receive from a son; with many sons one is not the happier — such is the rule."
20. When the lovely son, who had set all else aside, spoke thus, they, beloved of their kin, regained their joy; and the Lord, captivating with His charm, in the full beauty of boyhood, devoted Himself to serving His parents' feet.
21. Once, having eaten at home a roll of betel — the remnant [of an offering] to the chosen Deity, prepared by His own hand — the Lord suddenly fainted; coming round from the sprinkling of water from a fan and His mother's tears, He said:
22. "Mother, listen to Me: Vishvarupa told Me to renounce all this at once and leave. And I answered him: 'That is not fitting for us now: we are engaged in serving our father's feet.'
23. Hearing My words, he, full of deep love, at once pressed Me to his heart, embraced Me and said: 'Ah, dear one, on the path ordained by destiny, convey to father and mother my repeated obeisances.'
24. Having drunk his words like nectar — now, mother, that the bewilderment has passed, I know: 'I am he.' Where has my loving brother gone again? What is this?" — and in confusion He fainted again at once.⁵
25. Hearing these words of his son, whose greatness is inconceivable — [entering] his ears [and full of the meaning] of hundreds of Shrutis — Mishra thought: "He is the One who does even this, for His will is always fulfilled. Hari, Hari! What is this that has suddenly happened?" — and grew sad.
26. From that time, indifferent to sense objects, constantly contemplating Adhokshaja beyond the world, expecting nothing, his karma exhausted by austerity, he left his emaciated body and attained a form of bliss.⁶
27. When the father had departed, He, bathed in streams of tears — alas! — began to lament loudly and piteously; and Shachi, seeing her son's grief, her grief for her husband doubled, wept aloud like an osprey.
28. With their loud weeping, with cries of "ah, ah!" and with the tears of relatives and friends, the whole town was filled; people sank [into grief] as into a deep ocean — while the Lord for a moment became as one standing on the shore.

29. The townspeople, coming to Mishra's house, wept with them on the way and there; but some steadfast ones, gathering their strength, soon consoled with their counsel the excellent Lord together with His mother.
30. Then, to show what befits a son, the Lord of the world, in play, performed all the rites for His father; and [the father] — abode of all, ever fulfilled in his desires — shines as eternally liberated, for he is the father of Hari.⁷
31. Then, having duly performed the shraddha for His father together with all His friends, relatives and kinsmen, He enjoyed [life], surrounded by the retinue of the beauty of youth (*kaishora*), full of the play of love — as though by a great coronation.
32. Then the skilful and resourceful Vanamali, noticing that Shachi was intent on her son's marriage, displayed the adroitness that is [still] spoken of in connection with the Lord's wedding — [proposing] the daughter of Vallabhacharya.

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33. Having ascertained the standing of both families and consulted once more with Srivasa and other devotees, on a favourable day, together with assembled relatives and friends, they performed the rite of the binding word — the betrothal of bride and groom.
34. Before the wedding, to the loud sound of trumpets, the blessings of brahmins, dancing, singing and the rest, Gaurachandra with the best of His clan and the townspeople set out for His father-in-law's town.
35. Vallabha himself with his people came out to meet Him, who arrived with His relatives and in-laws; on the road the two parties met — a joy like the meeting of moon and ocean at the full moon.
36. Vallabha, versed in the Rigveda, having done everything according to rule, led the groom, the best of gods, to the altar, seated Him, washed His feet and honoured Him with a large golden seat, a grass mat and the other six gifts to a guest.
37. Bringing to Him his daughter, adorned with new clothes and ornaments — Lakshmi, incomparable among the young maidens of the world — he gave her to Him with a manifold dowry, as Himavat gave his daughter to Shiva.
38. Hari, pleased, took her hand in His, completed the remaining rites with the experts in wedding rites and, regaled with His wife and companions with delicious food — payasa, cakes, soups — stayed there.
39. The night, lovely with moonlight, desired by lovers, which had soothed the heat of day, lit by many lamps, filled with ringing songs —
40. that night, giver of various joys, He spent there with friends on many couches soft as moonlight, in merry talk and sleep.
41. When in the sky, as in a lake cleared of the mud of darkness, where the star-fishes had hidden, the swan [-sun] rose, eager for play — the buds of Hari's lotus eyes opened, and the dawn surely attained a pure autumnal beauty.
42. By the harsh cawing of crows, by the coolness of the touch of pearls, by the red glow in the east, by the bitterness of betel remnants, by the scent of opening lotuses, the people there — through their senses — at once understood in their hearts that morning had come.
43. Then the Lord, seating in front in an auspicious palanquin His beloved, Vallabha's daughter, with dancing and the like, set out for His own town as before, having satisfied His father-in-law and gladly accepted his gifts.

44. [He entered] the town — with lofty towers touching the clouds, girt with walls, with rich markets, with inner apartments full of noble ladies, with borders washed by the waves of the celestial river.
45. Sri Shachi meekly approached her daughter-in-law, the incomparable beauty of the three worlds, who bowed before her, and embraced her; and seeing her son, who had found a worthy wife, bowing too, she attained great joy in the world of men.⁸
46. Thus, when Hari, noble in deeds, had taken a wife, and His boyhood with its fierce lustre was gradually coming to an end, the moon of youth rose — beautiful, of fathomless charm, maddening men, enlivening a new art of graceful movements.
47. His feet [stole the beauty] of the red lotus, His knees — of [their like], His thighs — of plantain trunks and of elephant-posts, His flanks — of a pair of gourds, His waist — of the lion, His navel — of a whirlpool, His chest — of a door, His arms — of the trunks of lordly elephants, His neck — of the conch,

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48. His lips — of the bimba fruit, the row of His teeth — of pearls, His nose — of a freshly opened sesame flower, His eyes — of a pair of lotuses, His face — of the moon, His hair — of a dark chamara: all these limbs of the Lord, robbing them of their beauty, left everything else bereft of charm.⁹
49. Once this Hari, enchanting the hosts of gods and asuras in the form of Mohini, distributed the essence of nectar separately to the beautiful gods; now He has appeared again on earth, distributing the nectar of bhava to the devotees — "Is this not Mohini in male form?" — so people thought of Him then.¹⁰
50. In the *Sri Gaura-krishnodaya*, composed for the delight of connoisseurs by Govinda — a bee intoxicated by tasting the drops of honey that open within the lotus feet of Sri Gauranga, the bull among the lords of sannyasis — the fourth canto, flowing freely in verse and full of power, has come to its close.

Thus ends the fourth canto of the Sri Gaura-krishnodaya composed by Sri Govinda, named "The Marriage Performed."

1. The beginning of studies (*hate-khari*) and the upanayana — CC Adi 14–15. "The fifth season" is apparently hemanta (late autumn).
2. The *Kalapa* (*Katantra*) is the grammar studied in Bengal. Study under Gangadasa Pandita — CC Adi 15. Verse 4 is partly unclear.
3. CC Adi 15: the Lord asked His mother not to eat grains on ekadashi, and from then on she kept the fast. In Govinda-deva, also the introduction of Janmashtami and the Kartika vows.
4. Govinda-deva's own version. In the CC (Adi 15) Vishvarupa leaves home on learning that his parents intend to marry him — once and for all; in Govinda-deva he first became a monk (1.59–60), and now returns, stays at home and leaves again when his father plans his marriage. The sannyasa name Shankararanya — CC Adi 13 (Vishvarupa took sannyasa and under this name later left the world at Pandharpur, Madhya 9).
5. CC Adi 15: the Lord, after eating betel, fainted, and on coming to Himself said that Vishvarupa had called Him to take sannyasa, but He had refused for the sake of serving His parents, and Vishvarupa sent his respects to the parents. The words "I am he" (so '*ham asmi*') do not here carry the Mayavadi sense of identifying the soul with Brahman: they mean that the departed brother is now non-different from the Lord — cf. 1.42, 1.59 (Vishvarupa is Vishnu, present within the Lord); according to the tradition followed by Bhaktisiddhanta, Vishvarupa after his departure entered Nityananda.
6. The passing of Jagannatha Mishra — CC Adi 15 (briefly). Its connection with grief over Vishvarupa's departure is Govinda-deva's.
7. "The father of Hari": Jagannatha Mishra is, according to the GGD, Nanda Maharaja (cf. 1.41) — an eternal associate of the Lord, not a conditioned soul liberated by means of the rite. The second half of the verse may be corrupt in the edition ("abode of all, ever fulfilled in his desires" probably refers to the Lord).

8. Vanamali Acharya's matchmaking and the marriage with Lakshmipriya — CC Adi 15 (briefly), in detail CB, Adi-khanda. In Govinda-deva the groom travels with a wedding procession to his father-in-law's town.
 9. A traditional "head-to-foot" description of beauty (*nakha-shikha*), built on the image of "stealing" beauty from the objects of comparison. A few words in v. 47 are unclear.
 10. Mohini is the female avatara of Vishnu who distributed the nectar to the gods at the churning of the ocean (Bhag. 8.8–9). Cf. the CC: the Lord distributes the nectar of prema that had never been given before.
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Canto Five. Youth

The journey to East Bengal and Tapana Mishra; Lakshmipriya's departure; the marriage with Vishnupriya; the victory over the digvijayi; Gaya and initiation from Ishvara Puri; kirtan, the universal form shown to Advaita, the abhisheka; Nityananda and the six-armed form; Jagai and Madhai; Gopala Chapala; the subduing of the Kazi; the mango tree; the astrologer; Srivasa's son (pp. 24–27)

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1. Then Vishvambhara, surrounded by many disciples, knower of the Shruti, whose body is the ornament of the earth, detached, taking meritorious baths in rivers other than the Ganga too, displayed His pastimes in Vanga, like the Bodiless One [Kama].
2. Having conquered the local pandits there with various sciences, He then, again with humility, quickly bestowed His grace upon them and by apt arguments made them His devotees.
3. There lived a foremost brahmin named Tapana Mishra, who wished to determine the means [of attaining the goal] according to Kanada's doctrine. Having heard in a dream something of His greatness, he began to question Him — both from a desire to know and from a desire to win.
4. He Himself resolved his doubts completely and instructed him: "Best of brahmins, go to Varanasi; live in that city devoted to chanting My names until I come." And he did so.¹
5. Thus, wandering from town to town, the Best of men delivered men and women from hell; and in Vanga His path — with prints of the wheel, lotus, fish and conch — came to purify the earth like the Ganga.
6. Meanwhile Lakshmi, in her first youth, though long protected at home by her elders, bitten by the mighty serpent of heavy separation from her beloved, fell into a painful state and passed away.
7. The Omniscient, learning of this at once and of the time, though shaken at heart, kept His composure with steadiness; to soothe His mother's grief He returned home in due course, drawing after Him the hearts and eyes of the women of Vanga.²
8. Then He, an Indra among brahmins, dispelling Shachi's delusion of "mine" and "I", revealed the truth to her; having performed for His wife the rites that give unchanging happiness, He, the skilled teacher, went on sporting with His disciples.³
9. Shachi, worried that her son was left without a wife, thinking of the continuation of the line, took care of it and married her son to Sanatana Mishra's daughter Vishnupriya, incomparable among mortals.
10. Having performed the wedding rites only with an external mind and honoured His relatives with food and clothing, He rejoiced every day in singing the qualities of Mukunda, in sankirtana with hand-clapping, karatalas and the strains of the mridanga.⁴
11. One moonlit night, while the Lord was teaching His disciples on the bank of the celestial river, a certain scholar came to Him — a digvijayi, "conqueror of the quarters."
12. Though He received him with honour, he, full of envy, the thundering-voiced poet, spoke before the Lord: "You are famed as the pandit 'Nimai' — 'without guile'; I have come here to learn about your guilelessness."⁵
13. What have you studied, what remains to be studied, what do you teach these students? Having learned today of the power of your learning, gentle one, we have come to know your noble, universally beneficial nature."

14. Hearing his words, He, glad at heart, replied in speech full of humility and affection: "What can we say? Before you, who blaze like the scorching summer sun, we are fireflies.
15. We wish to hear your new poetry, which, like a beloved, holds friendship, *rasa* and *bhava* within; the poetry that praises the *Jahnavi* — a channel of a nectar pool, priceless, beyond words."

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16. Then the king of poets, hearing His friendly words — a thunderbolt among disputants, as if by the proud roar of conceit — at once praised the *Bhagirathi*, who dwells in the matted locks of the Lord of spirits [*Shiva*], in a hundred verses.
17. Then the Lord, choosing one verse, said: "Your verses praising the *Tripathaga* are victorious, astonishing the three worlds; explain to us, noble one, this one verse."
18. Saying this, *Achyuta* recited before him that verse — "*mahattvam...*". And he, the steadfast one, seeing that the Lord of the universe remembered at a single hearing, said with fear and amazement:
19. "The meaning of this verse is clear from the construction of its words — why examine its merits and faults? You know neither ornaments, nor merits, nor faults; and if you do know, child, why do you ask?"
20. Having said this, the best of poets fell silent. The Moon-faced One, seeing that he could not bear contradiction, spoke with a gentle turn of phrase that nevertheless shattered worldly [pride], to free the proud man of his pride:
21. "In this verse there are many hidden faults, and five obvious, gross ones — the chief of them *avimrishta-vidheyamsha*." Having thus examined everything, the Golden One explained it to him according to *Bharata* and other authorities.⁶
22. The brahmin, appreciating His skill in exposition, was at once at a loss before the Lord; bereft of arguments, his great pride crushed, he addressed the Lord with a glimmer of joy in his words:
23. "Seeing how you, even with a child's understanding, teach all the *shastras*, we have faith [in you]: my poetry, swift as a gust of storm, has been overcome by one who held it in memory."
24. Having thus honoured Him and considering himself defeated by a child, he, robbed of his wealth of meanings, went home, fasted, and at midnight, propitiating the goddess, told her about it.
25. The consort of *Hari* [*Sarasvati*], laughing, said to him: "Why do you grieve at being humbled by the Lord of all? Hundreds of learned *Sarasvatis* serve Him; I am His maidservant; what then of you!"
26. Enlightened thus by the auspicious [goddess], the aged brahmin at the end of the night went to the Lord's abode and, his heart pacified, with joined palms, crying "Glory!" and "Save me!", took shelter of His feet.
27. Graciously instructing him in the truth about Himself, He saved him by uprooting his evil tendencies; and likewise, as a father his sons, He made all people happy by instructing them in true knowledge.⁷
28. Then He, Himself the teacher of the three worlds, seeing [the need for] initiation, went to *Gaya*, a land of sacrifice holy as *Prayaga*, and there, taking shelter of *Ishvara*, disciple of *Sri Madhavendra Puri*, entered the *sampradaya*.
29. Having pleased him with service and respectful words and received his consent, the best of sages, wearing the *tilaka* that destroys *Kali*, beads of *tulasi* and the other marks of a *Vaishnava*, returned.⁸

30. From then on the Lord, in His own town, with Vakreshvara and other rasikas, performed the service of devotion to Himself — sankirtana, remembrance, glorification, obeisances and the rest — expert in bestowing prema, with many [other] of its limbs.
31. Then Advaita-deva, an ocean of mercy, a teacher of great intellect, came, eager to see Him; and Vishvambhara showed him His universal form, as [Krishna] showed it to Pritha's son in battle.⁹
32. His majesty... Srivasa and other honoured great [devotees] performed abhisheka over Gaura as the teacher of the world; and by the mercy of Chaitanya-chandra they themselves became teachers.¹⁰
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33. Once the moon of avadhutas, Nityananda-svarupa, came, wishing to see his brother. At the moment of their meeting He [Gaura] became six-armed, raising the conch, disc, the bow Sharnga, flute, lotus and [club].
34. Then the Lord shone four-armed, holding in His hands flute, conch and disc; and finally, [the desire] fulfilled, He, with fragrant body, appeared dark, threefold-bent, holding a flute.
35. Seeing Him shining in His former form, the avadhuta himself became Balabhadra — fair, with plough and club — delighting his followers and the devotees.¹¹
36. There lived two brahmins, ruined by their own deeds, named Jagai and Madhai; the ocean of mercy, having mercifully delivered these wretches, raised the banner of "Purifier of the fallen."¹²
37. Other devotees of the town gathered too, with the signs of prema — hair on end, faltering voice, rapt appearance; in Srivasa's house, the doors locked at night, they spent the days in sankirtana with Him.
38. A certain brahmin named Gopala Chapala, hearing [this kirtan] many times from outside and unable to bear it, at night unseen threw at the door things used in left-hand [Shakta] worship — wine and the like.
39. In the morning the great souls, seeing this filth, laughingly had it thrown away; and for this offence the slanderer, his body swarming with worms, suffered from leprosy, abandoned even by the Lord.¹³
40. From then on the townspeople daily performed sankirtana secretly in their homes with their families. Then the heretics, unable to bear it, ignorant of scripture, quickly informed their Yavana ruler.
41. And he, angered, sent armed men: "Forbid this!" — and these men of low character, by oaths and spies, strictly forbade [kirtan] throughout the town, in every house.
42. Hearing this, the Lord, enraged, frightened that sinful Mleccha with the form of Nrisimha and, organising a great festive procession led by Advaita and the righteous, set out [to him].
43. In front went Advaita, behind the avadhuta, and in the middle Haridasa danced with arms upraised; and He Himself, clearly seen everywhere, beheld the house of the ruler of the Yavanas.
44. He, in terror, at once came out before Him and with his whole heart took shelter of that Lord; and He, loving even to a Mleccha among the righteous, at once casting aside his scripture, instructed him in true scripture.¹⁴
45. Thus the Lord, performing many different deeds full of majesty, which He had wished for in various incarnations, by His mercy purified all the fallen — Mlecchas, cowherds, Shakas, Pukkasas, Kaulas and Shaktas.
46. Once, wearied by sankirtana, He entered the courtyard and planted a mango stone; that very moment a sprout appeared — and there was a tree with trunk, branches and foliage.

47. At once large fruits the size of palm fruits appeared on it, sweet and filling; a marvel: from then on, after every kirtan the host of His devotees was satisfied [with them].¹⁵
48. Then a certain astrologer came to the courtyard; the Lord asked him: "Who was I before?" He, after reflection, said: "You are the Lord of all"; but Gaurahari laughed: "I was a cowherd boy."¹⁶
49. Once after kirtan the son of Srinivasa, who had lived only a few years, died; the Lord, seeing him, quickly raised him, and by His power he delivered in the assembly a discourse on the truth of Brahman.¹⁷

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50. Thus, like the moon on the full-moon day, He gave joy to creation with a rain of the nectar of prema and in His mercy saw no fault in anyone. Therefore even the townspeople of stony nature, intoxicated with the nectar of prema, singing the names of Sri Krishna, cast off their fear of Yama and of the Yavanas.
51. In the *Sri Gaura-krishnodaya*, composed for the delight of connoisseurs by Govinda — a bee intoxicated by tasting the drops of honey that open within the lotus feet of Sri Gauranga, the bull among the lords of sannyasis — this fifth canto, on youth, radiant by its very nature, is drawing to its close.

Thus ends the fifth canto of the Sri Gaura-krishnodaya composed by Sri Govinda.

1. The journey to East Bengal and the instruction to Tapan Mishra — CC Adi 16: the Lord teaches him that the goal is prema and the means in Kali is chanting the holy name, and tells him to go to Varanasi, where they will later meet (Madhya 17). The mention of Kanada (Vaisheshika) is Govinda-deva's.
2. CC Adi 16: in the Lord's absence Lakshmi-priya, suffering in separation, left the world, "bitten by the snake of separation"; the Lord returned and consoled His mother. The image of the snake is the same as in the CC.
3. *Mukhaja-duścyavana*, "the Indra (Dushchyavana) of those born from [Brahma's] mouth", i.e. king of brahmins; a pun: Shachi is the name of Indra's consort. CC Adi 16: the Lord consoles His mother with reflections on the inevitability of fate.
4. The marriage with Vishnupriya — CC Adi 16. "With an external mind" — i.e. without worldly attachment.
5. *Nirmāyī* plays on the name "Nimai": "without maya, guileless." The victory over the digvijayi (Keshava Kashmiri) — CC Adi 16.
6. CC Adi 16 quotes this verse of the digvijayi ("mahattvaṁ gaṅgāyāḥ...") and the Lord's analysis: five faults (among them *avimrishta-vidheyamsha*) and five ornaments. Bharata is the author of the *Nāṭya-shāstra*, the founder of poetics.
7. CC Adi 16: at night Sarasvati revealed to the digvijayi that the Lord is her Master; in the morning he took shelter of the Lord and became a devotee. "Consort of Hari": in the Vaishnava interpretation Sarasvati is the Lord's energy (consort). Verse 23 is partly unclear in the edition; the translation is approximate.
8. Gaya and initiation from Ishvara Puri — CC Adi 17 (briefly), in detail CB, Adi-khanda. "Entered the sampradaya" — the line of Madhavendra Puri, which by Gaudiya Vaishnava tradition is in the succession of Madhva (Bhaktisiddhanta).
9. CC Adi 17: the Lord showed Advaita the universal form (vishvarupa), as Krishna did to Arjuna.
10. The beginning of the verse is unclear. The Lord's abhisheka (the mahaprakasha in Srivasa's house) — CC Adi 17; CB Madhya 9.
11. CC Adi 17: the Lord showed Nityananda the six-armed form (*shad-bhuja*); in detail, CB Madhya. Govinda-deva adds that Nityananda in response revealed the form of Balarama.
12. The deliverance of Jagai and Madhai — CC Adi 17; CB Madhya 13.
13. CC Adi 17: Gopala Chapala left at Srivasa's door the articles for worshipping Bhavani, with wine; for this offence against a Vaishnava he was struck by leprosy, and the Lord refused to forgive him until he begged forgiveness of Srivasa.
14. The Kazi and the ban on sankirtana — CC Adi 17: the Kazi broke the mridangas; the Lord came to his house with a huge kirtan procession; the Kazi admitted that Nrisimha had terrified him in a dream, and stopped the persecution. Govinda-deva's order: the Lord frightens the Kazi with Nrisimha, then goes in procession.
15. CC Adi 17: the Lord planted a mango stone in Srivasa's courtyard, and at once a tree grew with fruits without stone or skin; the devotees ate them after kirtan for a whole year.
16. CC Adi 17: the omniscient (*sarvajña*) astrologer, seeing the Lord, beheld Him as Krishna; the Lord told him that He had been a cowherd.

17. CC Adi 17: during kirtan at Srivasa's house a son died; the Lord bade the dead boy speak, and he told of the eternity of the soul and transmigration. Govinda-deva's "discourse on Brahman" (*brahma-vada*) means a discourse on the spiritual nature of the soul, not the Mayavadi doctrine.

Canto Six. Sannyasa

The students' insults and the resolve to take sannyasa; talks with Shachi and Vishnupriya; departure at night; sannyasa from Keshava Bharati at Katwa; three days in Radha-desha; the cowherd boys' trick; Advaita at the Ganga: "This is Vrindavana"; Shantipura; the feast at Advaita's house and the jests with Nityananda; the arrival of Shachi and the devotees (pp. 28–32)

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1. Once the Lord, abused without any cause in the town by students wandering here and there with harsh words, thought thus:
2. "If they perish by reviling Me — alas, what use is My mercy? Wishing to show mercy to these townspeople, even to those whose speech is harsh, I shall take sannyasa.
3. For those on earth who offend Me there is no other way: their way is to bow to Me; and [to bow] to a sannyasi is easy even for offenders."¹
4. Having thought this over, the Lord went home and at nightfall said to His mother in private: "Mother, how does this world appear to you? What do you perceive in your heart?
5. To Me it seems like death itself, terrible. Therefore, having restrained oneself and pacified [the senses], fixing the heart on this, one must conquer it — worshipping the feet of Hari, one must be freed."
6. When the Lord finished, Shachi, turning pale, seeing Him as if already walking the path of those who wear garments of bark, said nothing to her son, detached from everything."²
7. Having said this, Gaurahari, again and again soothing her sorrow, spent some days at home, sporting with His pure wife.
8. The beloved served her husband seeing Him as Hari, her in-laws and friends seeing them as elders; with good understanding, as a chaste wife, she enjoyed for a short time [the company of] the Lord, seeing Him as God.
9. One night the moon among knowers of mantras said to His unsuspecting wife: "Listen, O you who walk like a she-elephant: in this world you are a lamp..."³
10. Seeing constantly your tender body, shining only briefly like the unstable form of lightning, I am grieved today in the depths of My heart.
11. The Lord who is victorious in the world suddenly parts a pair of lovers; know that this is always His play; we should not grieve over it.
12. Therefore it has long seemed right to Me to remain unchanged even when a benefactor perishes; and you, do not pine in vain in separation from your kin.
13. He is dear to all embodied beings for whose sake all things are dear; therefore place your mind in the form of Hari and find peace in the Enchanting One."⁴
14. Having spoken these words, the Lord, who knows the meaning, embraced His wife and fell silent; but she, though embraced, found no joy, remembering His words, O Lord.
15. With flowers, ornaments, perfumes, new clothes, jests and loving play He pleased the woman and, content, again took delight with her through the night.
16. And at dawn, when a breeze blew from the slightly opening lotuses, the Lord, knowing no fear, leaving her asleep like a closed lotus bud, went out of the house.

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17. This young couple, like a pair of chakravakas by day, having taken much delight through the night — alas! — fell into the calamity of a separation of the night: the will of the Creator is never otherwise.⁵
 18. Learning of the Lord's intention, Mukunda, Acharya-mani [Chandrashekhara], the best of the twice-born, and the avadhuta, leaving behind worldly happiness, gladly followed Him.
 19. The Lord, knowing that the righteous would follow Him, fearing obstacles, resolved to take sannyasa and set out in haste the next day for the town named Katuka [Katwa].
 20. There the Lord came to Keshava Bharati and, bowing, [asked] for sannyasa; at his command, His lovely curls shorn, He became a mendicant monk who kept the shikha and the sacred thread.⁶
 21. When the twenty-fourth year had passed, in the bright fortnight of the month of Tapas, on Hari's day, having received Vaishnava initiation on earth, the Lord, intoxicated with the nectar of the Name, bowed down [to the guru].
 22. Adorned with staff, kaupina and waterpot, the Wise One, having taken leave of the guru too, resolving to go Himself to His own abode, Gokula, set out, free of the taint of desire.
 23. Not distinguishing His own body, the directions or places, drenched in the wine of joy and love, the king of sannyasis wandered hither and thither for three days in the land of Radha.⁷
 24. On the next day at sunrise three, headed by the avadhuta, saw the Lord. He asked them: "Why have you come here?" They replied: "To go with You to Vraja."
 25. Going with them, He asked some cowherd boys to show Him the way to Vrindavana; and they, instructed by the avadhuta, pointed out the way to the Ganga: "This is the road to Vraja."
 26. When in the morning the Lord, deceived by the boys' words, went toward the river of the gods, the incarnation of Balarama, having quickly thought it through, [said] secretly to Acharya-mani:
 27. "Go on ahead and tell Advaita everything the Lord is doing — in His name. Then quickly go on to Navadvipa, bring Shachi and show her her son."
 28. Thus instructed, the best of brahmins went to the Acharya and told him everything, and then, composed, to soothe Shachi's grief, went on from there to Navadvipa.
 29. The Lord, impelled by the false words of the sons of Vraja, rapt in prema, on the next day came to the best of rivers, the Vishnupadi, and with a jubilant heart threw Himself into it.
 30. "Ah, He Himself has fallen into the water that flows from His own big toe, and is Himself drowning in it!" — saying this, the two companions, holding His lotus hands, laughed.⁸
 31. Then Advaita, having crossed that river by boat, joyfully came up to Him and said: "Lord, put on this dry [cloth] and leave the wet kaupina here."
 32. Hearing his gentle words, Gaura, covering His body with embarrassment, said: "We have come to Vrindavana; how is it that you are here? You amaze us."
- [p. 30]
33. To this the humble best of brahmins, standing on the bank, smiling, said to Him: "Vrindavana is the abode where You, the Lord, shine.
 34. The water in which You play is the Daughter of the Sun [the Yamuna]; those who have taken shelter of You are the blessed residents of Vraja. Your wish to reach [Vrindavana], Lord, is as empty as a cloud's thirst to find water.
 35. And this Ganga, O Lord, having come into Vanga, through contact with You purifies the world again. May Your Lordship go from here to Shantipura and purify our house there."⁹

36. Gaura, honouring his words, put on the cloth and crossed the river in that boat with Advaita, Mukunda and Shesha [Nityananda].
37. "Ah, My elder, most venerable — the moon of the ocean of Padmavati's womb — has tricked Me and brought Me into Vanga!" — with this thought He entered the town.¹⁰
38. When the Lord entered Shantipura — happily unseen by those who hold false doctrines — He was surrounded by women with disordered garments and ornaments and by men absorbed in praising Him.
39. Some standing near Him said: "This is no man — this is the son of Soma, or the Bodiless One, descended here to sport with Ila and to increase the festival of love of the renunciants."¹¹
40. Others, seeing Him possessing nothing, said nothing, only looked at one another; having given Him the treasures of their eyes and hearts, they stood still like statues.
41. The best of Acharyas brought the noble One into his house, honoured Him with a seat and so on, and then, together with his wife Sita, began to prepare alms for Him in the house.
42. She prepared many dishes — things to chew, suck, drink and lick: rice of six kinds, with ghee, mung, washed — of various tastes, nectarean, clear;
43. payasa, barley porridge, rice, dal, many vegetable dishes of different sweetness, many cakes — of rice, urad, wheat and barley;
44. vadas fried in plenty of cow's ghee, crisp and tasty; dishes with young fruits and pieces of plantain; greens tasting like nectar;
45. fruits — seasonal ones, bunches of bananas, coconuts, jackfruit and the like; drinks without number, with curd, milk and cream.
46. The Acharya, at once filling beautiful cups three times with these and similar offerings rich in taste, offered them to Achyuta, and then, to feed the two brothers with devotion, seated them there, in Hari's house.¹²
47. Seeing this, the younger brother of the avadhuta, though pleased, said to the best of brahmins: "Such abundant alms are not fitting for mendicant monks. It is not good, venerable sir, to leave remnants; so give Me a little of this — something without taste."

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48. He, skilled in speech, with joined palms, lovingly answered His true and wholesome words: "According to the Shruti You, Lord, are the One; for such as You this food is fitting — is it not a mere handful?"
49. Hearing the words of Sita's husband, Gaurachandra smiled, began with His elder brother to eat all of it and, seated, jesting, tasting the vegetables and rice, asking "And what is this? And what is this?" — gave him joy.
50. Then Nityananda said to Advaita-deva: "I came here to break my fast after fasting five days; looking at your fare now, I think that by ill fate the brahmin must [again] go hungry today."
51. Advaita answered him, laughing: "Sir, this is just right for you, a ploughman and a great eater! I know: such a one cannot fill his belly-pot. You, a sannyasi, my lord, are punishing us brahmins."
52. Hearing this, the avadhuta, with feigned anger — "Why do you tease a mendicant?" — flung the alms-rice. At that Advaita, at once in ecstasy, danced with tears in his eyes, and the two [brothers], seeing him overflowing with prema, laughed with joy.¹³

53. Having eaten the rice and the rest abundantly and well, having performed achamana with pure water given by Advaita, refreshed [with betel] with camphor, cardamom and tulasi buds, the two, satisfied, anointed with sandal and the like, fell sweetly asleep.
54. Advaita, wishing to massage the Lord's lotus feet, at His command first ate with Mukunda and the other devotees; and the Lord, after sleeping a little, rose in the afternoon and held sankirtana with His devotees and the avadhuta.
55. So ten days passed. Then the best of Acharyas [Acharyaratna], seating Shachi in front in a palanquin, came with the townspeople to that town to see Gaurachandra — and, though worn with hunger, did not rest anywhere for a moment.
56. Loudly crying "Hari, Hari!" they filled [the town of] the lamp of Navadvipa-dhama; Advaita quickly lodged them all in the outer quarters, and Shachi, with tears in her eyes, entered Advaita's inner apartments.

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57. Seeing that His mother had come, the Lord, after the sankirtana, fell again and again [at her feet] on the ground, scorched by her grief. And she, weeping, embraced Him — with only the shikha left after His lovely curls were shorn — and said: "My child, is it you?.."
58. Clasping her feet and consoling His mother with humble words, Gaura lovingly went out, wishing to see the devotees from the town; and they, seeing Him in saffron garments, with a thin shikha, with only the thread for ornament, fell to the ground with broken hearts.
59. Raising them one by one — Vakreshvara and the others, Srivasa, Shridhara, the humble Sri Vidyanidhi, Gangadasa and other brahmins, sages, Muslim townsmen, all the townspeople down to the cowherds, children and elders — the Lord gladdened them.
60. Advaita Prabhu entertained those who had come — gave them fine quarters, food and drink, shrikhanda, seats, beds and so on; and Gaurachandra, worshipping Hari morning and evening with the townspeople — with singing and dancing — and then cherished by His mother, stayed there.¹⁴
61. In the *Sri Gaura-krishnodaya*, composed for the delight of connoisseurs by Govinda — a bee intoxicated by tasting the drops of honey that open within the lotus feet of Sri Gauranga, the bull among the lords of sannyasis — the sixth canto, on sannyasa, has come to its close.

Thus ends the sixth canto of the Sri Gaura-krishnodaya composed by Sri Govinda.

1. CC Adi 17: the students, irritated because the Lord had beaten one of them with a stick, insulted Him; the Lord thought that unless they were saved they would perish, whereas to a sannyasi they would bow — and so be purified. Therefore He decided to take sannyasa.

2. CC Adi 17 and Madhya 3 briefly; in more detail the CB, Madhya-khanda. "Those who wear garments of bark" — hermits.

3. The end of the verse is corrupt in the edition; we translate what is intelligible.

4. Cf. *Brihadaranyaka Upanishad* (2.4.5): "Not for the husband's sake is the husband dear, but for the sake of the Atman." In Govinda-deva this Atman is Hari, "the Enchanting One" (Manohara). The farewell conversation with Vishnupriya — cf. CB, Madhya-khanda; in Murari and Lochana Dasa — in detail.

5. Chakravakas, according to poetic convention, are separated at night; here it is the reverse: the young spouses were together at night and parted at dawn.

6. Sannyasa at Katwa — CC Adi 17, Madhya 3. Govinda-deva stresses that the Lord kept the shikha and the thread, and calls the initiation "Vaishnava" (v. 21) — that is, he depicts the Lord's sannyasa as a Vaishnava sannyasa. Cf. 6.57–58: before His mother's eyes is a "thin shikha."

7. Three days in Radha-desh — CC Madhya 3. "Tapas" is the month of Magha; CC (Adi 17): the Lord took sannyasa at the end of His twenty-fourth year, in the bright fortnight of Magha.

8. CC Madhya 3: Nityananda told the cowherd boys to show the Lord the way to the Ganga, saying it was the road to Vrindavana; the Lord entered the Ganga, taking it for the Yamuna. The companions' jest: the Ganga flows from the toe of Vishnu's foot.
9. CC Madhya 3: Advaita met the Lord in a boat, gave Him a dry cloth and said: "Wherever You are, there is Vrindavana," — and the Lord understood that Nityananda had tricked Him.
10. Padmavati is Nityananda's mother. "Elder": so the Lord respectfully calls Nityananda (cf. 6.47: Gaura is "the avadhuta's younger brother").
11. The son of Soma (the Moon) is Budha, the husband of Ila. A pun: *ilā* also means "earth." "Renunciants" — sannyasis.
12. CC Madhya 3: Sita and Advaita prepared a huge feast for the Lord and Nityananda; Govinda-deva lists the dishes, as does Krishnadasa Kaviraja.
13. CC Madhya 3: the jesting quarrel of Advaita and Nityananda at the meal and the rice flung by Nityananda — a loving squabble between two friends; Advaita dances on receiving the remnants.
14. CC Madhya 3: Shachi and all the people of Navadvipa came to Shantipura; the Lord spent ten days there in kirtan, and Shachi cooked for Him. The word *khāna* in v. 59 ("khans") probably means Muslim townsmen.
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Canto Seven. The Journey to Nilachala

Shachi's plea and the promise to live in Nilachala; the Lord appears to Shachi at her offering; the road to Puri; Remuna: the story of Madhavendra Puri, Gopala and Kshirachora; Varaha at Jajpur; Cuttack: Sakshi-gopala and the story of the two brahmins (pp. 33–36)

[p. 33]

1. Then His mother said to the Lord of the world: "How can You, the Protector of all, turning away from Your wife and abandoning Your mother, take up the last ashrama? Ah, what is this?"
2. Son, at this age, fit for the joys of life, while I am alive — for You, a scholar endowed with such qualities, this dress is unfitting; to endure so many hardships is but a speck of merit [for one like You]."
3. Saying this in a voice broken by tears, she wept like a child; and He, saddened by His mother's grief, after long thought said to Shachi:
4. "Mother, My body, which you gave Me, has become fruitless, deprived of serving you: in My folly I chose the life of a mendicant monk and gave up My hair, My homeland and My dress.
5. I have done what ought not to have been done; yet I do not think it right to return to the former ashrama. Tell Me where you would like — there I will live year after year.
6. And if you, mother, together with your daughter-in-law, always wish to see Me — every morning, dear one, you will see Me eating the food offered to the household Deity."
7. Though instructed by her son's words, she, longing for her son, said to the Lord: "Your good is my good; if so, live, child, in Nilachala."¹
8. Gaurachandra accepted her words, saying "So be it," and, bowing, sent His mother off: "Be gracious, mother, return home with the townspeople."
9. And she, accepting the Lord's command, somehow returned with her countrymen to her land, leaving her life in her eyes and her heart in her son, and [bringing home] only her body.
10. From then on the worthy wife [Shachi], together with her daughter-in-law, at home, imagining Him as her son, worshipped with various foods the Deity of the Lord [Vishnu] whose banner bears the enemy of serpents.
11. And every morning the Lord swiftly appeared before her; delighting His mother and her companion, He ate the food offered and vanished.²
12. For as anyone conceives of the Lord in the heart, so He appears before him; does not the Lord of all abide [everywhere]?
13. When His mother had gone to her town, He, having spent some more days in that town, took leave of the noble Acharya and of Haridasa and set out for Nilashaila.
14. The departing Lord was followed by the moon of avadhutas, Mukunda Datta, the Pandita named Jagadananda, and Damodara Pandita.³
15. Gathering alms now in one town, now in another, Gaura-Krishna, going along the bank of the celestial river, came with them to the town named Remuna.

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16. Seeing there the Deity guarded only by the eyes of the people, named "the Thief of Sweet Rice" (Kshirachora), the Lord, out of supreme love for the son of the king of Vraja, spent the night in that town.

17. Having performed sankirtana and worship with His four devotees and rejoicing, He asked the avadhuta and the others in amazement about the origin of the Deity's name.
 18. Asked by the Lord as He sat in the courtyard, they joyfully told the glory, surpassing the world, of the best of Puris named Madhavendra:
 19. "Listen, Gaurahari: once the lord of Puris, Madhavendra, at the Lord's command came to Vraja to revive it — where, because of the oppression of the Yavanas, [the worship of the Lord] by the people had disappeared.
 20. Having searched everywhere, he found not a single Deity and, exhausted by long wandering, came to the foot of Govardhana hill.
 21. As he sat there, a cowherd boy brought milk and said: 'Drink this milk, don't sit as if stupefied; stay here, monk, you are hungry — satisfy your hunger.'
 22. When this boy, a son of Vraja in disguise, having given him the pot of milk, quickly went away, Puri, drinking that nectarean milk, attained knowledge of the three times.
 23. Where in the grasses, bushes and bowers the Deity was hidden — all that the boy showed him, the untiring one, in a dream.
 24. Delighted, the king of sages at the end of the night saw before him the Holder of Govardhana; having massaged, cleaned, anointed, bathed and adorned Him, he installed [the Deity].
 25. Then, going from forest to forest, with many forest-dwellers he gradually gathered other Deities too and installed them all in most beautiful temples built by the wealthy.
 26. Having arranged for each separately the articles of worship and lovely servants, he himself set out for Nilashaila to bring sandalwood, which relieves the heat of the body [of Gopala].
 27. On the way, going as he pleased, this ascetic stayed at Advaita's house and, favouring that noble one with a confidential great initiation, then came to this [town].⁴
 28. Seeing the eye-enticing body of this Purushottama, the wise man spent the night here, [wondering]: 'What is the nectarean sweet rice of the [Deity's] remnants like here?'
 29. The God of gods, knowing that very instant this desire of the best of sages, Himself then gave him a pot of the sweet rice offered to Him.
 30. The best of sages, tasting the sweet rice, said 'I have attained everything,' and left. Since then He bears this name, though it is shameful for Him — for He loves His servants.
 31. Puri, fleeing the man-eating demon of fame, ran away from the town of Remuna and in a few days beheld at Nilagiri Jagannatha, dear to the self-possessed.
 32. Now he rejoiced looking at Him, now sang aloud, now danced; seeing his behaviour, the people of Utkala gave him alms with great eagerness."
- [p. 35]
33. "Hearing of his glory, the great men of Purushottama themselves brought much sandalwood and gave it to him for his Deity.
 34. After a few days the untiring ascetic came again to this [town]; and the Lord commanded him: 'Offer that sandal to Me here.'
 35. Then, having ground the sandal with camphor, at the command 'Anoint His body every night,' when the hot season was over, the wanderer joyfully went to Vraja."⁵
 36. Learning thus of the devotion of Madhava, the best of mendicant monks, and of how the Knower of Vraja [Krishna] submits to His devotees, He, an ocean of steadfastness, was overwhelmed by the

onrushing flood of prema.

37. Having spent the night there with the righteous, the Lord, composed, set out in the morning and with His well-wishing devotees saw the beautiful Varaha at Viraja-kshetra.
38. In the very moment of seeing Him — out of love for the people — He came on to Cuttack, where the summits of towers like crystal mountains gleam and touch the sky.
39. Coming to this city, like the city of Purandara, the Lord, delighted — greeted by the bowed heads of rows of people — reached the abode of [the Deity] named Sakshi.
40. Passing the gate of that wise abode, guarded by a pair of fierce lions, Gaura with the avadhuta and the others saw the God seated on the lion throne.
41. Seeing Him — the colour of the atasi flower, threefold-bent, charming, a magnet for the eyes, known on earth by the name Sakshi — the Lord was deeply stirred.
42. Dancing and crying "Glory to Krishna! Hari! Glory to the lord of Vraja! Glory to Govinda! Glory to Achyuta!" — with hair standing on end, faltering voice, trembling, perspiration, change of colour and tears of joy, He fell senseless.
43. Seeing Him fallen to the ground, the avadhuta and the others raised Him and, reviving Him with the fragrant water left from the worship of Hari, spent the night there.
44. When the Lord asked about the origin of the name "Sakshi" of the son of the lord of Vraja, the best of avadhutas, who knew all the old story, joyfully told Him:
45. "Listen, Lord: once two brahmins lived in Vidyanagara; one was senior in age, learning and birth, the other was lowly.
46. Once these two, of one mind, joyfully visiting many holy places, by great fortune came to Vraja, to the abode of Vrindavana, wishing to stay there.
47. Having visited the forests, hills, lakes, bowers and tirthas and bathed in the waters of the Yamuna, they saw this Lord at Keshi-tirtha and stayed there in joy.
48. There the younger greatly pleased the elder by diligent service; and he, pleased, promised this younger one his daughter.
49. The lowly one, considering such a promise of a daughter impossible, asked the noble one [to swear] before a divine witness, and he made this Gopala witness."

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50. "Having spent some days there, both brahmins returned home; the younger, after living at his own place, came to the elder and asked for the long-promised daughter.
51. The old man, surrounded by sons, friends and wife, abused him: 'A lie!' — and all those assembled, hearing him, did not acknowledge [the promise].
52. Hearing this untruth, the lowly one turned pale and in fear said to the assembly: 'How can he reject the truth, when the witness is the Witness of the three worlds!'
53. Hearing this, all the old man's relatives said to him with laughter: 'So be it — if this witness of yours, wretch, comes here Himself.'
54. Spurred by these words, the lowly one went to Vraja and, seeing this Lord, repeatedly laid [the case] before Him so that He would bear witness, and then, renouncing [everything], lay down there [fasting].
55. At midnight the Lord told him: 'Why are you suddenly bewildered, brahmin? Go. For the fulfilment of your wish I will follow you on the road, jingling My ankle bells.'

56. Having drunk the nectar of these words, his hunger and thirst gone, firm in his vow, he, when the sun rose, in great joy came after some days to his town.
57. Hearing on the road the jingling of His ankle bells, the best of brahmins, entering the outskirts, began to doubt whether the Lord was following him and, turning his head, looked back.
58. And as soon as he looked, the Lord stood still on that very spot. Seeing Him, the best of brahmins joyfully informed the cruel brahmins of the town.
59. Hearing his words, the townspeople at once beheld the Witness with their own eyes and entered great bliss; the old man, as if bound, came there and gave his daughter to that brahmin. Served by both of them, this Vishnu remained there, worshipped by the king of Karnata.
60. Once a certain king Purushottama, having conquered Kanchi, brought Him home with honour; and He lovingly accepted the new pearl that shone in the queen's nose, making a hole for it in His own nose."⁶
61. In the *Sri Gaura-krishnodaya*, composed for the delight of connoisseurs by Govinda — a bee intoxicated by tasting the drops of honey that open within the lotus feet of Sri Gauranga, the bull among the lords of sannyasis — the seventh canto, on the journey to Nilachala, has come to its close.

Thus ends the seventh canto of the Sri Gaura-krishnodaya composed by Sri Govinda.

1. CC Madhya 3: Shachi asks her son to live in Jagannatha Puri so that she can receive news of Him; the Lord agrees.
 2. According to the CC (Antya 3 and elsewhere), the Lord promised His mother to come to her every day and eat what she offered; Shachi often saw Him eating her offering. "Her companion" is apparently Vishnupriya.
 3. CC Madhya 3, 5: the Lord went to Puri with Nityananda, Jagadananda, Damodara Pandita and Mukunda. In v. 13, "the noble Acharya" is Advaita.
 4. CC Madhya 4 tells in detail of Madhavendra Puri: the milk from the cowherd boy, the finding of Gopala on Govardhana, the journey to Puri for sandalwood; on the way Madhavendra initiated Advaita in Shantipura; in Remuna Gopinatha "stole" a pot of sweet rice for him — hence the name Kshirachora-Gopinatha.
 5. CC Madhya 4: Gopala in a dream told Madhavendra to anoint Gopinatha in Remuna with the sandal, since They are one. In Govinda-deva the command is condensed: "offer it to Me here." In the CC the narrator is the Lord Himself; in Govinda-deva the story is told by Nityananda and the companions.
 6. CC Madhya 5: the story of Sakshi-gopala — of the two brahmins from Vidyanagara; Gopala followed the younger, jingling His ankle bells, and stopped when he looked back. Later King Purushottama, having conquered Kanchi (Vidyanagara), brought the Deity to Cuttack, and the queen gave Him the pearl from her nose. In Govinda-deva the narrator is Nityananda (as in the CC). "The king of Karnata" is probably the ruler of Vidyanagara.
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Canto Eight. The Gift of Prema to the People of Utkala

Bhuvaneshvara; the broken staff; ecstasy before Jagannatha and Sarvabhauma; Gopinatha Acharya proves the Lord's divinity; seven days of Vedanta and the critique of Shankara's commentary; the universal form and Sarvabhauma's conversion; the Dola-yatra and festivals; prasada for Sarvabhauma; departure for the south from Alalanatha (pp. 37–40)

[p. 37]

1. Having heard the story of the Beloved of the cowherd women, whose wealth is faithfulness to His word, and having understood all about the guilt and innocence [of the two brahmins], the Omniscient One, gazing again and again at the shining Lord, went on with love, keeping Him in His heart.
2. Having seen in the Ekamra forest the linga Bhuvaneshvara and the place of Kapotesvara on the [river] Bhargavi, the Lord gave His staff to His brother and, as soon as He glimpsed the temple [in the distance], went on ahead in a surge of love.
3. Then the avadhuta, together with the devotees, broke the staff and, purified by serving Him, ran after Him. Ahead, at Atharanala, they said sorrowfully: "Master, do not go alone in such a rush!
4. Seeing You, Lord, with Your heart melting with love, who can help You? Let us all go together, having bowed to blue-throated Shambhu, to the face of the dark Moon."
5. Hearing His brother speak, the Lord asked: "And where is the staff — My helper, who bears My fatigue?" To this the lord of the earth [Nityananda] answered Him with love and fear, hiding a smile in the corners of his lips:
6. "When You, overcome with prema, absorbed in dancing, fell to the ground, O Destroyer of sin, I caught You — and from the weight I fell beside You, and the staff broke at that moment, today, in the first watch."¹
7. Angered over the staff, as if furious, He ran on ahead, leaving the devotees — a forest fire for the dry trees of sin; and as soon as He lovingly reached Sri Jagannatha, He fell unconscious, flooded by the waters of prema.
8. Seeing Him senseless on the ground, Sarvabhauma Bhattacharya, who happened to be near, said: "Who is this handsome mendicant monk who has come and fallen, shaken to the depths of his soul?"
9. All said: "No one knows who he is or where he comes from; on seeing the Lord he fell to the ground. He seems an enviable monk; therefore you should take him home so that he may recover."
10. At their word the Bhattacharya had his students carry Him on their shoulders to his house and sat beside Him; seeing that His breath was perceptible only by the trembling of a wisp of cotton, he took His body in his hands for a moment and gently rubbed it.
11. "How could this blazing sattvika emotion appear in this human body? Or is this God Himself, assuming a human guise to reveal devotion to Himself?"
12. While the Bhattacharya was thinking thus, the Lord's servants, having seen the Supreme Lord in the temple and fulfilled [their desire], and having heard from the people the news of the Lord, came there anxiously together with Nityananda.
13. Seeing Sri Chaitanya, the best of monks, unconscious, sheltered in the Bhattacharya's house, they, led by Nityananda, lovingly sang a song cooling to the ear, reviving.

14. With a roar, taking the sweetness of that song into His heart, dancing loudly, rising together with them, out of the abundance of love He endlessly made the sprouts of joy grow in the eyes of those who watched.
15. Seeing this, the Bhattacharya rose in delight together with Gauranga and the townspeople in the assembly and, bowing low to His lotus feet, [offered] to give alms to Him and to the devotees, weakened with hunger.²

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16. Accepting his words, the Lord also accepted the alms — various dishes lovingly given by the god on earth [the brahmin] — and stayed with him, like a fire that has hidden its brilliance under ash.
17. Gopinatha, called Acharya, His countryman, also came there and bowed his head to Gaura's feet; and the Teacher of all blessed the one He knew: "May your mind, smiling with joy, rest in Krishna."³
18. Disregarding this blessing, the Acharya [Sarvabhauma] at a suitable time said to the Lord: "Lord, if you hear from me the meaning of Vedanta, you will attain, great one, the knowledge that destroys difference."
19. Having said this, toward evening he showed Him the Lord [Jagannatha] with His companions, and at the end of the night again gave Him abundant alms; so he spent the night, and in the morning relieved Him of His fatigue.
20. He asked Gopinatha: "Who is he, what is his name, from whom did he receive initiation, this friend of yours?" To this question his sister's husband answered his brother-in-law the Bhattacharya: "He is the Lord of the world!"
21. He was born in Navadvipa to the best of brahmins, Mishra, and received initiation from the noble one named Keshava Bharati. He cares nothing for 'senior' and 'junior' — Sri Chaitanya delivers by [His] consciousness alone.
22. [People say:] 'In the age of Kali there is no incarnation of Krishna' — let that opinion be, O follower of convention. He is Bhagavan Himself, established by the scriptures, possessed of the fullness of majesty, untouched by worldly enjoyments.
23. Of His sannyasa and golden radiance Vyasa spoke in the *Brahma[-purana]*, at the beginning of the *Bharata* and in his own words; in the *Vayu Purana* he clearly revealed His nature. Therefore, best of brahmins, do not be proud before Him."⁴
24. Having heard Gopinatha's words, the best of the twice-born smiled; having bathed and served Gaurahari, he, in a secluded house, surrounded by righteous men, humbly began to expound the Vedanta to Him.
25. For seven days He listened to the sutras of the Shruti and, considering [the commentary] useless, did not even part His lips. This troubled the best of brahmins, and he, smiling slightly, asked: "Have you understood this or not, Sir?"
26. Hearing these words of the Acharya, the best of sannyasis said: "This is mastery of exposition, O well-wisher. The meaning of the sutra shines in it like the sun, but your commentary appears as a bank of clouds covering it.
27. What is directly expressed by the words of the Shruti — the meaning of the pranava — how does it become figurative in your hands, O [knower of] the highest meaning? Leaving aside the Tara [Om], you take the Shruti statement 'tat tvam asi' — a partial statement; this is not right."⁵

28. The reality whose body is concentrated light of being and consciousness is Brahman, and the Purusha is His conscious form. Non-different from Him and eternal are [the energies] of conscious and unconscious kind — like the ocean and its waves; and this [world] is a well on the shore.
29. Do you accept that the jiva is a part of the Lord, or not? If it is a part of the Whole — where is it, tell me, and who is it? But if you say that reality is one and indivisible because there are no parts — then who, separately, is the one whose body is the universe?
30. Therefore non-difference is clear only in the statement about manifestation: if the jiva is not what is illumined [by Him], what do you take it to be? If Brahman is non-dual, then, with the [grammatical] non-difference of the genitive, who will be the Antaryami, the supreme being?
31. The Brahman said to be above all is Bhagavan; and what is lower He bears as His body. To assert the equality of these two, O gentle one, is your transgression, and is it not a grave one? Speak, good man!

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32. In the Vedanta it is not said that Brahman is without attributes: on the contrary, since none is equal to Him, He shines as possessed of attributes. God, having created the universe by this [energy], Himself unchanging, plays in it; He undergoes neither transformation nor illusory change.⁶
33. 'From which, in which, by which' — know, brahmin, that these three causes [are named] in the scripture that speaks of His distinctive attributes. Why then do you call Bhagavan, who has a form of being, consciousness and bliss, formless, although He is the source?⁷
34. In His portion of bliss is [the energy] named hladini; in the portion of consciousness, the one named sandhini; and in the portion of being, the one named samvit. In the three portions of Him who is Brahman, these three energies of the Lord, according to the Shruti, are eternal.⁸
35. And when the Shruti says 'without hands, without feet' and so on — that is the denial in the Lord of a material [body], not [His] essence; in the formless there could be no breathing and the like. Vyasa established this in all the Puranas.
36. Acharya Sri Shankara, concealing this highest truth, taught otherwise in this age; this is not his fault — for at the Lord's command he, being most disciplined, [taught] this doctrine of maya."⁹
37. Thus, whatever arguments he put forward, relying on all the commentaries on the sutras — in each of them his power was crushed by Gaura's words, and the god of the earth [the brahmin], though a great speaker, fell into despondency.
38. To him — worthy of association, reproaching himself, bowing down, intelligent — the Lord out of compassion, to save him, revealed to the astonished man the fullness of His majesty and His two feet, raining the nectar of love.
39. Seeing Him four-armed and then two-armed, the Bhattacharya in amazement realised the Supreme Truth and, bowing down, with a purified heart, praised the One famed in holy verse with a hundred shlokas.¹⁰
40. When in him — his throat choked with tears and longing, his hair standing on end — there played the restless sidelong glance of Vishnu, by that contact he, formerly engaged in harsh logic, at once became a deliverer from the cycle of rebirth for himself and for others.
41. When the Bhattacharya began to practise bhakti, the devotees on earth readily came to worship the moon of Gaura; he became the flagstaff in the procession that crushes the hordes of heretics — skilled in the Shruti together with [the chanting of] the Name.

42. Thus, shedding streams of prema, He lived in his house until the end of spring; and there the Lord saw the swing pastime of the Lord of Nilachala together with Haladhara.
43. At the end of the month of Phalguna, preparing to celebrate the festival of coloured powder (phalgu), to play in moon-bright festive rites, standing on a chariot like one with a hundred banners, before which dancing girls sang sweetly —
44. Sri Govinda [the festival Deity], like the moon, dispelling darkness from afar, delighting the chakora-devotees, filling the earth with fragrance, relieving the heat, bearing disc and conch —
45. along the road lit by many lights, in the holy place of Vishnu — as long as the God moved, the ocean of prema of the best of Gauras kept rising.
46. Every day dancing with His servants in boundless joy, drawn toward the God as if by the reins of a loving thirst, like a ship on the ocean driven by a favourable wind, the son of Shachi spent five nights thus.
47. When on the previous night offerings had been made into the fire, auspicious for the welfare of the world, on the full moon in the morning on a high long platform the faultless swing pastime of Vishnu took place,

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48. [where there were] rows of pillars, waterpots, wheels and many raised banners, and above the middle a swaying canopy, waving chamaras and shining ornaments.
49. While the God, in the clear shady pavilion, in such play, which raises the joy of the three worlds, enjoyed divine offerings, the Lord [Gaura] with the townspeople served Him.
50. When clouds of coloured powder veiled the place, people gazed unblinking like the gods at Him — the Supreme Lord absorbed in dancing — and themselves became just as eager.
51. When the Lord fell senseless out of joy at [the sight of] the remnants of the worship of the Smiling One, there was a crush — like a host of gods intoxicated with joy — of people with bodies wet with sweat, full of praise.
52. Some there, somehow joining their palms above their heads and gazing at that joy, loudly proclaimed "Glory!" with the name of Achyuta, and so made fruitful the years of their long lives.
53. Having served the God thus, the righteous at the end of the night carried Him with the greatest reverence to His abode and, installing Him there, absorbed in bliss, went to their homes, having seen the Lord of all beings.
54. Then, in the month of Chaitra, seeing the festival of Rama's appearance on Rama-navami, the worship of damanaka and other celebrations, clearly radiant with fragrance, Chaitanya joyfully served the God above the gods.¹¹
55. One morning in the month of Madhava, having seen the Lord of Sri and taken the remnants of His offering, He lovingly ran to the learned Bhattacharya, wishing to know his heart.
56. When he ate that [prasada] without even washing, He considered the whole land of Utkala blessed; and then Gaura wished to deliver quickly Karnata, Dravida and other lands [still] uninstructed.¹²
57. When the day at his house drew to a close, the Generous One, having taken alms and seeing the Acharya standing above all on earth in bhakti, honoured the other blessed ones and set out — on the mission of the touch of prema.
58. After the departing [Lord] ran the townspeople with melting hearts, crying: "Master, where are You going, leaving us, Your own?" — like the people [of Ayodhya] after Rama.

59. The Lord, though indifferent to this, accompanied by His own, came in the evening [to Alalanatha] and, seeing the Lord named Alalanatha, held sankirtana there with them in the assembly, with dancing.
60. Having spent the night there thus, the Lord humbly sent them back, saddened, to Purushottama and, at the avadhuta's word, free from desires, set out for the south together with Krishnadasa.¹³
61. And they, having let Him go, who had departed on the southern path like the sun — self-controlled, by agreement — returned, powerless in the days of His [northward] course, as if parched by the hot breath [of separation].
62. In the *Sri Gaura-krishnodaya*, composed for the delight of connoisseurs by Govinda — a bee intoxicated by tasting the drops of honey that open within the lotus feet of Sri Gauranga, the bull among the lords of sannyasis — the eighth canto, on the gift of prema to the people of Utkala, has come to its close.

Thus ends the eighth canto of the Sri Gaura-krishnodaya composed by Sri Govinda.

1. CC Madhya 5: on the way the Lord gave His staff to Nityananda, who broke it into three pieces and threw it into the river Bhargi (Bhargavi); the Lord grew angry and went on to Puri alone. Nityananda's explanation ("You fell, I caught You, and the staff broke") is as in the CC.
2. CC Madhya 6: the Lord, seeing Jagannatha, lost consciousness; Sarvabhauma had Him carried to his house; His companions came and revived Him with loud kirtan. The Bhattacharya fed them with prasada.
3. CC Madhya 6: Gopinatha Acharya, the Lord's countryman from Navadvipa and Sarvabhauma's brother-in-law, recognised the Lord. The blessing "may your mind be fixed on Krishna" the Lord gave to Sarvabhauma, who considered it a Vaishnava's blessing [inferior to what befits a sannyasi]. The phrasing in the edition is unclear; following the CC we refer the blessing to Sarvabhauma.
4. Gopinatha's debate with Sarvabhauma and his students on the Lord's divinity — CC Madhya 6. "At the beginning of the *Bharata*" — probably the *Vishnu-sahasranama* of the *Mahabharata* (with the names "golden in colour ... sannyasi"), quoted in the CC (Adi 3.49–50). The references to the *Brahma Purana* and *Vayu Purana* follow tradition; cf. 1.2.
5. CC Madhya 6: the Lord says that Shankara interprets the sutras not directly (*mukhya-vritti*) but indirectly (*lakshana*); the principal statement (*maha-vakya*) of the Vedas is the pranava (Om), while "tat tvam asi" is a partial (*pradeshika*) statement. Govinda-deva follows the CC.
6. A refutation of the doctrine of *vivarta* (illusory transformation) and of the *parinama* of Brahman itself; according to the CC (Madhya 6), the world is a transformation (*parinama*) of the Lord's energy, while the Lord Himself is unchanging. Verses 28–31 are partly obscure in the edition; the translation conveys the course of the argument.
7. A reference to the *Taittiriya Upanishad* 3.1 ("from which all beings are born, by which they live, into which they enter") and to *Vedanta-sutra* 1.1.2 ("from whom is the birth and so on"): Brahman, as the cause of the world, possesses attributes.
8. Govinda-deva's order differs from the CC (Adi 4.62, Madhya 6): there sandhini is the energy of being (*sat*), samvit the energy of consciousness (*chit*), hladini the energy of bliss (*ananda*). Probably parts of the verse are transposed (or the text is corrupt); we translate as printed.
9. CC Madhya 6 and Adi 7: Shankara at the Lord's command concealed the truth and preached Mayavada; no blame attaches to him (Padma Purana: "In the age of Kali, in the form of a brahmin, I shall proclaim this false doctrine"). Bhaktisiddhanta consistently repeats this judgement: Shankara is an incarnation of Shiva carrying out his commission.
10. CC Madhya 6: the Lord showed Sarvabhauma first a four-armed form, then the form of Krishna with the flute; Sarvabhauma composed a hundred shlokas in His honour.
11. The festivals of Puri (Dola-yatra, Rama-navami, the worship of damanaka) are mentioned only briefly in the CC. Govinda-deva, an Oriya, describes the rites of Puri in detail; this is one of his independent features. According to the CC (Madhya 7), the Lord left for the south soon after Sarvabhauma's conversion, in the month of Vaishakha.
12. CC Madhya 6: the Lord brought Sarvabhauma Jagannatha's prasada early in the morning, and he ate it without washing — thus transcending the Vedic rules; the Lord embraced him and said that now He was at peace.
13. CC Madhya 7: the Lord went south with the brahmin Krishnadasa, given Him as a servant on Nityananda's advice; at Alalanatha He danced in kirtan and sent the devotees back.